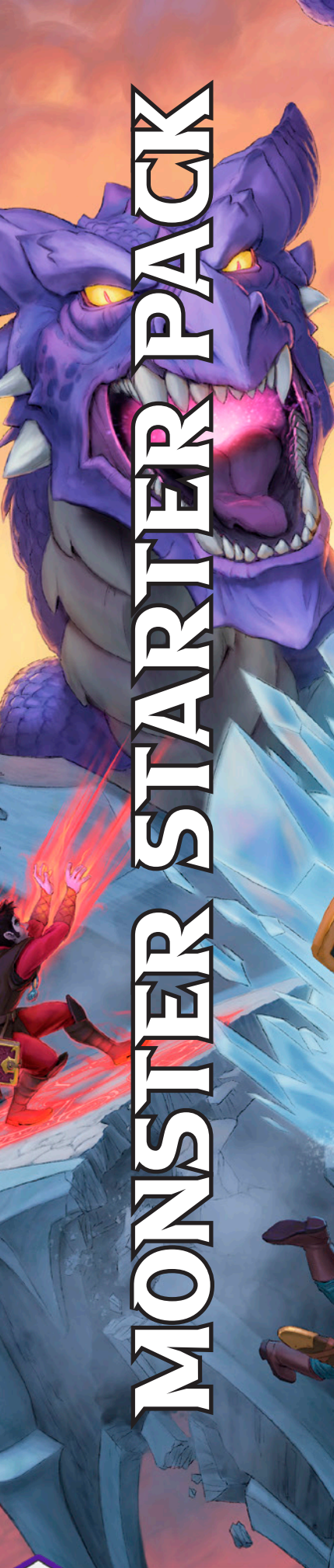




MONSTER COLLECTION



MONSTER COLLECTION

The Monster Collection is your comprehensive guide to making monsters in *DC20*! This PDF comes with tons of information for you to use to make your own homebrew monsters, while giving you the tools to make sure they're balanced. Not only that, since it also includes monsters we've made as examples for you to use, complete with lore and tactics! Get out there and create something truly fun and/or terrifying to throw at your players!

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CONTENTS

MONSTER COLLECTION	2
MONSTER COLLECTION	3
DC20 COMBAT PHILOSOPHY	3
BUILDING A MONSTER	3
Monster Statistics	4
Monster Offense	4
Monster Survivability	6
Monster Speed	7
Monster Action Points	8
Monster Traits	8
Monster Roles	10
BUILDING AN ENCOUNTER	13
Encounter Budget	13
Encounter Difficulty	13
Advanced Actions	14
Example Encounters	15
BESTIARY	16
Angelic Herald	16
Animated Armor	17
Animated Doll	18
Bandit	18
Bandit Captain	19
Brown Bear	19
Cherub	20

Earth Tortoise	20
Fairy Dragon	21
Fiendish Harbinger	22
Fire Lizard	23
Ghost	24
Honey Ooze	25
Ice Raven	26
Imp	26
Juvenile Purple Drake	27
Mandrake	27
Manticore	28
Mantrap Bloom	29
Molten Glass Ooze	30
Ogre Warrior	31
Pixie	32
Skeleton Warrior	33
Small Mimic	33
Sprite	34
Storm Elemental	35
Swarm of Bats	36
Wolf	36
Wyvern	37
Zombie	37
DC20 GLOSSARY	38

MONSTER COLLECTION

Creating exciting, fair, and memorable battles is at the heart of *DC20*. This document provides tools and guidelines for building monsters and designing combat encounters that challenge your players without overwhelming them. You'll learn how to balance enemy strength, damage output, action economy, encounter difficulty, and how many enemies overall.

BUILDING A MONSTER

Building a monster in *DC20* means fine-tuning a few key statistics to strike the right balance between challenge and fun. By adjusting these numbers, GMs can design encounters that stay exciting and fair, keeping players engaged without making the fight too easy or too punishing.

DC20 COMBAT PHILOSOPHY

These are the core design philosophies for a standard *DC20* Combat:

- **Accuracy:** Attacks have a **65% chance to hit** targets.
- **Balance:** A Monster is about as strong as the same level PC
- **Quantity:** There are the same amount of monsters fighting the same number of PCs.
- **Difficulty:** Combat Encounters are designed for **Medium** difficulty.
- **Duration:** Combat Encounters last an average of **3 Rounds**.

DC Tip: Medium difficulty monsters are designed to be killed by PCs of the same level in 3 Rounds to ensure the design goal of 3 Round Combats is met.

Example: If an average Combat Encounter lasts **3 Rounds**, a PC makes **1-2 Attacks per Round**, and the PC have a **65% chance** to hit the monster with an Attack, then the PC would make **4-6 Attacks** across the 3 Rounds and hit the monster with **3-4 Attacks**. If the monster needs to be defeated in those 3 Rounds, then the Attacks each need to deal **25%-33%** of the monster's **max HP** to defeat it.

MONSTER STATISTICS

To begin designing a monster, use the statistics below as a foundation. These values represent the baseline for an average monster at each level, providing a balanced starting point before applying role-specific adjustments or unique Traits (see Monster Traits section for more information).

LEVEL	AVERAGE HP	AVERAGE PD/AD	ATTACK BONUS	SAVE DC	PRIME MODIFIER	COMBAT MASTERY	TRAIT VALUE
Novice	7	10	+2	12	2	0	2
0	11	11	+3	13	2	1	4
1	13	12	+4	14	3	1	6
2	15	12	+4	14	3	1	8
3	19	13	+5	15	3	2	10
4	20	13	+5	15	3	2	12
5	24	15	+7	17	4	3	14
6	25	15	+7	17	4	3	16
7	28	16	+8	18	4	4	18
8	30	16	+8	18	4	4	20
9	34	17	+9	19	4	5	22
10	36	18	+10	20	5	5	24
11	40	19	+11	21	5	6	26
12	42	19	+11	21	5	6	28
13	44	20	+12	22	5	7	30
14	46	20	+12	22	5	7	32
15	50	22	+14	24	6	8	34
16	51	22	+14	24	6	8	36
17	55	23	+15	25	6	9	38
18	56	23	+15	25	6	9	40
19	60	24	+16	26	6	10	42
20	62	25	+17	27	7	10	44

MONSTER OFFENSE

A monster's offensive power defines its role in combat and shapes how players experience the encounter. Whether it's a brutal melee bruiser, a cunning ambusher, or an arcane threat that controls the battlefield, its damage output and attack design determine how dangerous it feels. Balancing a monster's offense ensures that every encounter is tense and exciting without becoming unfair or overwhelming. The following guidelines will help you set appropriate damage values, design balanced attacks, and fine-tune how your monsters challenge the party.

MONSTER DAMAGE

Since Combat Encounters are designed to last **3 Rounds**, a monster's **Damage per Round** should be based on the **health of a PC** of an equal level and the desired **monster difficulty**. The table below lists the average amount of damage a monster should deal per **Attack**, organized by **level** and **difficulty**. Use these numbers as a baseline when designing or adjusting monster attacks.

LEVEL	EASY	MEDIUM	HARD	VERY HARD	DEADLY
Novice	0.25	0.25	0.5	1.5	2
0	0.25	0.5	1	2	2.5
1	0.25	0.5	1	2	3
2	0.5	1	1.5	3	4
3	0.5	1	2	3.5	5
4	1	1.5	2.5	4	6
5	1	1.5	2.5	4.5	6.5
6	1.5	2	3	5.5	7.5
7	1.5	2	3.5	5.5	8
8	1.5	2.5	4	6	9
9	1.5	2.5	4	7	10
10	2	3	5	8	11
11	2	3.5	5	8.5	12
12	2.5	4	5.5	9	13
13	2.5	4	6	9.5	14
14	3	4.5	6.5	10	14.5
15	3	4.5	6.5	10.5	15.5
16	3.5	5	7	11.5	16
17	3.5	5	7.5	12	17
18	4	5.5	8	12.5	18
19	4	5.5	8	13	18.5
20	4.5	6	9	13.5	20

Low Level Damage: The damage value of an Attack can be less than 1 at early levels - especially on Easy difficulty.

Half Increments: When the damage value is divisible by 0.5 (such as 1.5, 2.5, or 3.5), the Attack has the **Impact** Property (deals +1 damage on a Heavy Hit).

Examples

- **1.5** = The monster's Attacks deal 1 damage and have the Impact Property
- **0.5** = The monster has 2 AP and its Attacks deal 1 damage
- **0.25** = The monster has 2 AP and its Attacks deal 0 damage and have the Impact Property

DEADLY

Monster damage per Round equals **3/4 or more** of a PC's total HP. PCs are expected to reach **Well-Blooded (25% HP)** within 1 Round.

VERY HARD

Monster damage per Round equals **1/2** of a PC's total HP. A PC is likely to fall to **Death's Door (0 HP)** in 2 Rounds - 1 Round before the monster would be defeated.

HARD

Monster damage per Round equals **1/3** of a PC's total HP, typically bringing them to **Death's Door** in 3 Rounds - the same time the monster might be defeated.

MEDIUM

Monster damage per Round equals **1/4** of a PC's total HP, reducing them to **Death's Door** in 4 Rounds - 1 Round after the monster would be defeated.

EASY

Monster damage per Round equals **1/5** of a PC's total HP, dropping them to **Death's Door** in 5 Rounds - 2 Rounds after the monster would be defeated.

DC Tip: If a monster deals less than **1/5** of a PC's HP per Round, the Combat Encounter will be trivial unless fought in overwhelming numbers. For faster resolution, consider running such scenarios as **Combat Skill Challenges** instead of standard battles.

MONSTER ATTACKS

When designing a monster's Attacks, consider how many creatures each Attack can target, how much damage it deals, and how many Action Points (AP) it should cost. These guidelines help ensure that monsters feel balanced, dynamic, and appropriate for the difficulty.

Single-Target Attacks: An Attack that targets only 1 creature should cost **1 AP**.

Multi-Target Attacks: An Attack that targets 2 or more creatures (such as an **Area Attack**) should cost **2 AP**. You can adjust this based on the size and reach of the **Area of Effect**.

Example: A typical Level 1 PC has about **9 HP**, so a Level 1 monster in a **Hard** difficulty Combat Encounter should deal about **2 Damage per Round**.

Single Target Attacks: If the monster makes **2 Attacks** per Round, each Attack should cost **1 AP** and deal **1 damage**.

Multiple Target Attacks: If the monster makes **1 Attack** that targets 2 creatures (such as a 3 Space Sphere), the Attack should cost **2 AP** and deal **1 damage**. If that Attack targets 3 or more creatures (such as a 5 Space Sphere) then it should deal half as much damage (**0.5 damage**) or cost more AP (such as 3 or 4 AP).

DYNAMIC ATTACK SAVES

You can reduce the damage of a monster's Attack by 1 to add a **secondary effect** (such as **Bleeding**, **Burning**, **Prone**, **Grappled**, **Slowed**, or **Stunned**). When you do, the Attack becomes a **Dynamic Attack Save** and the target must make a Save (chosen by the GM when they create this special Attack).

DC Tip: Remember, when making a Dynamic Attack Save, the target takes the Attacks damage on a Hit, and suffers the secondary effects on a failed Save. They could be hit by the Attack but avoid its secondary effects, be missed by the Attack but suffer its secondary effects, or any other possible outcome.

This approach allows monsters to feel flavorful and tactical, emphasizing control and disruption rather than pure damage output. It also helps diversify combat encounters, ensuring that not every threat comes from how hard a creature hits, but how cleverly it can shape the battlefield.

Example: If an Attack deals 2 damage, you could add reduce the damage by 1 to add the **Bleeding** Condition to the Attack. Alternatively, you could increase the cost by 1 AP (or by 2 AP if the Attack targets multiple creatures) to add the **Bleeding** Condition.

Multiple Effects: You can create Attacks that apply multiple effects (such as multiple Conditions or multiple stacks of the same Condition) by decreasing the damage per added effect.

DC Tip: Some Conditions are very powerful (such as **Paralyzed**, **Petrified**, and **Unconscious**). The cost of adding these Conditions to an Attack should be increased, so that the damage is reduced multiple times for each of these powerful Conditions added to the Attack.

MONSTER SURVIVABILITY

A monster's **survivability** determines how long it can stay active in combat and how much effort the party must invest to defeat it. In *DC20*, survivability is shaped primarily by three core stats: **Health Points**, **Defenses**, and **Resistances**. Balancing these elements ensures your monsters feel threatening without dragging out the fight or making the encounter frustrating. Each stat plays a distinct role in defining how survivable a creature is on the battlefield.

HEALTH POINTS (HP)

Health represents a monster's raw endurance. The more HP it has, the longer it can withstand attacks before being defeated. Increasing HP makes a monster more reliable over time, since it can continue to take hits even when facing multiple attackers or high-damage characters. However, giving a monster too much Health can make battles feel slow or repetitive, so it is often better to pair moderate HP with other defensive tools like Resistance or crowd-control abilities.

DEFENSES (PD AND AD)

A monster's **Precision Defense (PD)** and **Area Defense (AD)** determine how hard it is to hit.

- **Precision Defense (PD):** Protects against attacks that are made against a specific target.
- **Area Defense (AD):** Protects against wide-reaching attacks that cover an area, usually containing multiple targets.

Raising these Defenses reduces how often the monster gets hit by attacks rather than how much damage it takes. High Defenses work well for well protected or highly evasive creatures, but too much avoidance can make encounters feel unfair or slow if the party struggles to land hits.

RESISTANCES

Resistances reduce the amount of damage a monster takes after being hit. They represent natural toughness, armor, or magical wards that blunt the impact of attacks. Granting Resistance is an effective way to make a monster feel resilient without relying solely on high HP. For example, an armored knight might resist physical damage, while an elemental spirit resists fire or cold.

DC Tip: True damage can't be reduced or mitigated in any way, so Resistance doesn't work against it. It's recommended to avoid giving monsters abilities that deal True damage.

DAMAGE REDUCTION (DR)

Damage Reduction is a special form of Resistance that only reduces damage from **normal Hits**. It does not protect against **Heavy Hits** or **Critical Hits**, which bypass this protection. Against normal Hits, DR functions the same as Resistance, reducing the monster's incoming damage by a set amount or percentage. This makes DR a useful tool for monsters that should shrug off light attacks but remain vulnerable to strong, well-placed strikes.

DC Tip: Physical Damage Reduction (PDR) works against Bludgeoning, Piercing, and Slashing damage. Elemental Damage Reduction (EDR) works against Cold, Corrosion, Fire, Lightning, and Poison damage. Mystical Damage Reduction (MDR) works against Psychic, Radiant, and Umbral damage.

BALANCING SURVIVABILITY

When designing a monster, consider how **HP**, **Defenses**, and **Resistances** work together to create its defensive profile. A stone golem might rely on high HP and Resistance to physical attacks, while a nimble assassin survives by relying on high Defense and evasive movement. Balancing these traits ensures your monsters feel distinct, appropriately durable, and fun for players to fight.

Balancing HP & Defenses: If you raise a monster's **HP**, consider lowering its **Defenses** proportionally (and vice versa). This keeps the monster from becoming too difficult or taking too long to defeat, maintaining a fair and engaging challenge for the PCs.

Balancing Resistances: Likewise, **Resistance** (and **Damage Reduction**), which lessens the effect of incoming attacks, should be balanced with **HP** and **Defenses** to avoid making the monster overly resilient. Thoughtful tuning of these stats ensures that combat remains tense and rewarding without becoming frustrating or repetitive.

DC Tip: *Monsters can have higher overall survivability, but they should have compensating weaknesses (such as lower damage output or limited mobility). Pairing a tough, defensive creature with fragile, high-damage allies helps maintain balance so that the full encounter still resolves in about 3 rounds.*

UNDERSTANDING PC DAMAGE

Base Damage: The average damage of a PC's base Attack is 1.5 damage (Weapon damage plus Properties such as **Impact** or **Heavy**). The additional damage from potential Heavy, Brutal, and Critical Hits is + 0.65 damage on average, for a total average of 2.15 damage per Attack.

Damage Enhancements: A Level 1 PC can spend 1 SP (or 1 AP) to increase the damage by 1, or 1 MP to increase the damage by 2 (although less often). For the examples below, we'll assume 1 SP was spent to increase the damage by 1, making a Level 1 PC's Attack deal an average of 3.15 damage.

Class Features: Roughly half of all Class Features can increase the overall damage of a PC's Attack (such as **Cheap Shot**, **Rage**, or **Smite**) whether directly (bonus damage) or indirectly (ADV or Attack bonus). For each Class Feature, the PC's damage per Round increases by 0.5, or 0.25 per Attack (assuming 2 Attacks per Round). A Level 1 PC has 2 Class Features, so they deal an average of 3.65 damage per Attack.

Example: Standard Monster

Monster Defense: A Level 1 PC has an Attack bonus of +4. A Level 1 monster should have an average Defense of 12 to ensure the PC has a 65% chance to hit.

Monster HP: The PC needs to defeat the monster in 3 Rounds, and they will hit the monster with 4 times ($6 \times 65\% = 4$) during that time. This means the PC will deal

14.6 damage in 3 Rounds ($3.65 \times 4 = 14.6$), so the Level 1 monster needs to have roughly 15 HP.

Example: Low Defense & High HP

Monster Defense: If you reduce a Level 1 monster's average Defense to 10, a Level 1 PC ends up with a 75% chance to hit the monster.

Monster HP: The PC needs to defeat the monster in 3 Rounds, and they will hit the monster an average of 4.5 times ($6 \times 75\% = 4.5$) during that time. This means the PC will deal 16.4 damage in 3 Rounds ($3.65 \times 4.5 = \sim 16.4$), so the Level 1 monster needs to have roughly 17 HP.

Example: High Defense, PDR, & Low HP

Monster Defense: If you increase a Level 1 monster's average Defense to 14 and grant them **PDR**, a Level 1 PC ends up with a 55% chance to hit the monster where 25% of their Attacks that deal Bludgeoning, Piercing, or Slashing damage will deal halve damage.

Monster HP: The PC needs to defeat the monster in 3 Rounds, and they will hit the monster an average of 3.3 times ($6 \times 55\% = 3.3$) during that time. This means the PC will deal 12 damage in 3 Rounds ($3.65 \times 3.3 = \sim 12$), so the Level 1 monster needs to have roughly 12 HP.

MONSTER SPEED

A monster's **Speed** determines how far it can move each time it takes the Move Action (1 AP). In **DC20**, most monsters are designed with a **Speed of 5**, which matches the default Speed of PCs. This makes encounters predictable and balanced, allowing both players and GMs to plan movement and positioning around similar rates of motion.

ADJUSTING SPEED

Speed should vary for monsters that are naturally faster or slower than humanoid characters. Creatures known for agility, flight, or swiftness might have higher Speed to reflect their mobility, while slower, lumbering monsters should have lower Speed to emphasize their cumbersome nature.

Fast Monsters: These monsters can harass ranged or weaker characters, reposition frequently, or threaten multiple areas of the battlefield. A **warhorse** might have a Speed of 8, allowing it to charge across the battlefield and engage or disengage quickly.

Slow Monsters: These monsters often rely on durability, area control, or powerful attacks to compensate for their limited mobility. A **turtle** or **golem** might have a Speed of 2, moving deliberately and requiring strategic positioning to become a threat.

MONSTER ACTION POINTS

Most monsters have **4 Action Points (AP)**. They use AP during their Turn to take **Actions**, or during another creature's Turn to take **Reactions** if the situation allows.

SPENDING ACTION POINTS

How a monster spends its Action Points defines its combat style, level of threat, and overall impact on the battlefield. A creature that focuses all its AP on a flurry of attacks can quickly overwhelm a wounded PC, while one that mixes movement and strikes can control the battlefield and pressure multiple targets at once.

- **Heavy Attack:** Empower a single, devastating attack (Attack Action + Enhancements).
- **Multi-Attack:** Make multiple attacks in a single turn (repeated Attack Action).
- **Move & Attack:** Move and strike to gain positional advantage (Move Action + Attack Action).
- **Signature Ability:** Trigger special abilities, defenses, or support effects (Spell Action or Trait).

Thoughtful AP use raises the tension of combat and pushes players to adapt their tactics, manage their resources wisely, and coordinate as a team to overcome the monster's shifting strategies. Here are some common examples of how monsters can spend their AP:

ADJUSTING ACTION POINTS

You can adjust a monster's AP to control how many Actions or Reactions it can take each Round. Increasing AP makes a creature more versatile or dangerous, while decreasing AP limits its activity but can make encounters faster and easier to manage.

INCREASING ACTION POINTS

Due to the **Multiple Check Penalty**, granting extra AP has diminishing returns, since each repeated Check beyond the first gains stacking DisADV, making them less and less effective. Rather than adding more AP directly, consider giving the monster **Reaction Points** to improve its responsiveness without extending its turn time (see the **Advanced Actions** section).

DECREASING ACTION POINTS

Since movement requires spending AP to take the **Move** Action, monsters should usually have at least **2 AP** so they can move and attack in the same Turn. **Minions** have **2 AP**, making them quick and simple to run while still contributing meaningfully to the encounter (see the **Dynamic Monsters** section).

MONSTER TRAITS

Monsters can be granted **Traits** to give them unique strengths, weaknesses, and special abilities. These Traits help define a monster's identity, making encounters distinct, memorable, and strategically engaging. By assigning at least **one Trait per monster**, you create opportunities for players to adapt their strategies and face a variety of challenges. Traits can highlight a monster's role in combat, its personality, or its connection to the environment, ensuring that every encounter feels different.

Example: A shadowy creature might have a Trait that makes it difficult to detect but vulnerable to light-based attacks (such as the **Light Spell** or **Radiant damage**).

DC Tip: Certain Traits can increase or decrease a monster's damage, HP, or Defenses. It is highly recommended that you not grant a monster more than 2 of any kind of these Traits.

MONSTER TRAIT VALUE

When referencing the **Monster Statistics Table** to determine the appropriate **Trait value** for a monster at a given level. The number shown represents the total value provided by that monster's Traits. Each Trait a monster possesses (whether offensive, defensive, or utility-based) contributes to this total. A single strong Trait might account for the full value, while several minor Traits could combine to reach it.

DETERMINING TRAIT VALUE

The value is based on how much bonus AP it provides per 3 Round Combat (1 Trait Point = 2 AP).

DC Tip: 1 Monster Trait Point is equal to 1 Ancestry Trait Point, so you could easily add Ancestry Traits to Monsters!

EXAMPLE TRAITS

Below are examples you can apply at a glance to give a monster **Traits**. These can be mixed and matched to suit the creature's role and theme. If the cost of a Trait is negative, then it grants that many Trait Points to spend on additional Traits.

OFFENSE

- **(4) Enrage:** Once you become **Bloodied**, gain +1 damage on all Attacks.
- **(2) Opportunist:** Deal +1 on **Heavy Hits** to creatures affected by at least one Condition.
- **(2) Pack Tactics:** Gain an additional +2 bonus to Attacks while **Flanking** a creature.

DEFENSE

- (2) **Unrelenting:** The only way you can be reduced below 1 HP is by a Heavy Hit or an Attack that deals Radiant damage.
- (2) **Regeneration:** Heal 1 HP at the start of each of your turns.
- (2) **Death's Door:** This monster can use the **Death's Door** mechanic like PCs, making near-fatal situations more dramatic and strategic.

UTILITY

- (2) **Shot Caller:** When you use the Help Action on another creature, its next Attack deals +1 damage.
- (2) **Inspire:** Once per turn, give a Help Die to an allied creature for free.
- (4) **False Appearance:** While motionless, you're indistinguishable from a specified object.

STATISTICS

- (2) **Attribute Increase:** +1 to 1 Attribute (up to Prime Modifier).
- (-2) **Attribute Decrease:** -1 to 1 Attribute (minimum of -5).
- (4) **Damage Increase:** The damage increases based on its Level as shown in the Damage Change Table. This is roughly a 25% increase in damage.
- (-4) **Damage Decrease:** The damage decreases based on its Level as shown in the Damage Change Table. This is roughly a 25% decrease in damage.

Damage Change Table

LEVEL	EASY	MEDIUM	HARD	VERY HARD	DEADLY
Novice	+0	+0	+0	+0	+0
0	+0	+0	+0	+0	+0
1	+0	+0	+0	+0	+0
2	+0	+0	+0	+0.5	+0.5
3	+0	+0	+0.5	+0.5	+1
4	+0	+0.5	+0.5	+1	+1
5	+0.5	+0.5	+0.5	+1	+1.5
6	+0.5	+0.5	+1	+1.5	+2
7	+0.5	+0.5	+1	+1.5	+2
8	+0.5	+1	+1	+2	+2.5
9	+0.5	+1	+1.5	+2	+3
10	+1	+1	+1.5	+2.5	+3
11	+1	+1	+1.5	+2.5	+3.5
12	+1	+1.5	+2	+3	+4
13	+1	+1.5	+2	+3	+4
14	+1	+1.5	+2	+3.5	+4.5
15	+1.5	+1.5	+2.5	+3.5	+5
16	+1.5	+2	+2.5	+4	+5
17	+1.5	+2	+2.5	+4	+5.5
18	+1.5	+2	+3	+4.5	+6
19	+1.5	+2	+3	+4.5	+6
20	+2	+2.5	+3	+5	+6.5

DC Tip: Remember, **0.5** damage can be added by just granting a monster the **Impact Property** (+1 damage on Heavy Hits or higher).

- (4) **HP Increase:** +25% HP.
- (-4) **HP Decrease:** -25% HP.

DC Tip: Add or subtract a monster's **Well-Bloodied** value to increase or decrease its HP by 25%.

- (1) **Defenses Increase:** +1 to 1 Defense.
- (-1) **Defenses Decrease:** -1 to 1 Defense.

MOVEMENT

- (1) **Speed Increase:** +3 Speed.
- (-1) **Speed Decrease:** -1 Speed.
- (4) **Fly Speed:** Fly Speed equal to Speed.
- (4) **Burrow Speed:** Burrow Speed equal to Speed.
- (2) **Swim Speed:** Swim Speed and can breath underwater.
- (2) **Climb Speed:** Climb Speed and Resistance (Half) to Falling damage.
- (2) **Truewalk:** You can walk normally on solid surfaces regardless of their orientation (such as upside down on the ceiling) without falling or needing to Climb.
- (2) **Incorporeal:** You can move through solid objects and creatures. If you end your turn inside an object or creature, you take True damage equal to 25% of your maximum HP.

SENSES

- (1) **Darkvision:** Darkvision 10 Spaces.
- (2) **Tremorsense:** Tremorsense 3 Spaces.
- (2) **Blindsight:** Blindsight 3 Spaces.
- (4) **Truesight:** Truesight 10 Spaces

DAMAGE MITIGATION

- (1) **Damage Reduction:** Damage Reduction to Physical, Elemental, or Mystical damage.
- (2) **Resistance:** Resistance (Half) to 1 damage type.
- (-2) **Vulnerability:** Vulnerability (Double) to 1 damage type.
- (4) **Immunity:** Immunity to 1 damage type.
- (8) **Absorption:** Immunity to 1 damage type and regain HP equal to 1/2 damage.

CHECKS & SAVES

- (1) **ADV on Skill Checks:** ADV on 1 Skill Check (such as Awareness, Athletics, or Trickery).
- (-1) **DisADV on Skill Checks:** DisADV on 1 Skill Check (such as Awareness, Athletics, or Trickery).
- (1) **ADV on Attribute Save:** ADV on 1 Attribute Save (Might, Agility, Intelligence, or Charisma).
- (-1) **DisADV on Attribute Save:** DisADV on 1 Attribute Save.
- (1) **Condition Resistance:** ADV on Checks & Saves against 1 Condition.
- (-1) **Condition Vulnerability:** DisADV on Checks & Saves against 1 Condition.
- (2) **Condition Immunity:** Immune to 1 Condition.



EXAMPLE MONSTERS

Traits are a flexible tool that allows GMs to craft monsters with **distinct personalities, combat roles, and tactical depth**. By combining offensive, defensive, and utility Traits, you can create creatures that challenge the party in new ways while keeping encounters engaging and dynamic.

WOLF

The **Wolf** is a Level 0 Soldier that can have 4 Trait value. Consult the Example Traits section for information on the named Traits.

- (-2) Attribute Decrease
- (1) Darkvision
- (1) Keen Senses
- (2) Pact Tactics
- (1) Speed Increase (+2)
- (1) PD Increase (+1)

SKELETON WARRIOR

The **Skeleton Warrior** is a Level 1 Soldier that can have 6 Trait value. Consult the Example Traits section for information on the named Traits.

- (2) False Appearance
- (1) Darkvision
- (4) Poison Immunity
- (2) Bleeding Immunity
- (2) Disease Immunity
- (-2) Bludgeoning Vulnerability (Double)
- (-2) Radiant Vulnerability (Double)
- (-1) Speed Decrease (-1)

BANDIT CAPTAIN

The **Bandit Captain** is a Level 1 Leader that can have 10 Trait value. Consult the Example Traits section for information on the named Traits.

- (4) Damage Increase
- (2) Attribute Increase
- (-4) HP Decrease
- (-4) Defense Decrease x 2
- (2) Inspire
- (5) **Inspiring Aura:** Their Inspiring Aura grants **other** Monsters within 5 Spaces ADV on Charisma Saves. Assuming there are 4 PCs and an equal number Monsters, this would benefit 3 other Monsters (which is likely given the size of the Aura). If a Monster is forced to make a Save 1 time per Round in a 3 Round Combat (3 total Saves), and 3 Monsters gain this benefit (9 total Saves), then this will grant **9 AP** per Combat (ADV is worth 1 AP).
- (5) **Rally:** Their Rally grants 1 Temp HP to other Monsters within 5 Spaces at the start of its turns. Assuming there are 4 PCs and an equal number Monsters, this would benefit 3 other Monsters (which is likely given the size of the Aura can cover most of the battle map). Assuming each Monster is Attacked 1.5 times per Round, 1 of those Attacks hits, and the Attack deals at least 1 damage, then Rally is worth **9 AP** per Combat.

GRANTING CLASS FEATURES

Monsters can also gain **Class Features** or versions of them, giving them traits typically associated with PCs. For instance, a monster could have a Champion's **Adaptive Tactics**, a Cleric's **Channel Divinity**, or a Rogue's **Cheap Shot**, allowing for more dynamic and versatile encounters. A Class Feature is worth roughly 2 Trait value for a monster.

Example: A **Goblin** with a Rogue's **Cunning Action** and **Cheap Shot** can strike quickly and exploit vulnerabilities in the party's defenses (4 total Trait value). A **Giant** with a Barbarian's **Rage** Feature can deliver devastating attacks that test the party's endurance and planning (2 total Trait value).

DC Tip: Using Class Features on monsters is a great way to showcase abilities from Classes that are not represented by the party's PCs, giving players a sense of the wider possibilities within the game.

MONSTER ROLES

Monster roles describe how a creature can be used most effectively in combat. They help GMs select monsters that work well together and fulfill different functions during a battle. These roles do not provide mechanical bonuses or penalties by themselves, but they give insight into how a monster was designed and how it might behave in combat alongside others.

UNDERSTANDING A ROLE

Each role lists its main **Strengths** and **Weaknesses** and the **Tactics** its role employs.

STRENGTHS & WEAKNESSES

These terms help you understand where the monster excels and where it may struggle.

- **HP:** Maximum Health Points.
- **Regeneration:** Ability to restore health to self or allies.
- **Defense:** Precision Defense (PD) and Area Defense (AD).
- **Damage:** Damage output and offensive capabilities.
- **Close-Range:** Effectiveness within 1 to 2 Spaces.
- **Mid-Range:** Effectiveness within 3 to 10 Spaces.
- **Long-Range:** Effectiveness at 11 Spaces or farther.
- **Mobility:** Movement speed and flexibility.
- **Evasion:** Ability to avoid or negate attacks.
- **Crowd Control:** Ability to restrict or hinder enemy actions.
- **Zone Control:** Ability to shape the battlefield or influence movement.
- **Bufs:** Ability to enhance allies or provide helpful effects.
- **Debufs:** Ability to weaken or hinder enemies.

TACTICS AND GAMEPLAY

The suggested tactics for each role are recommendations. They show one way to use the role effectively in combat. GMs should feel free to adapt these ideas to suit the story, encounter, or player strategies. Creativity is encouraged.

BRUTES

Brutes are tough, high-damage monsters that excel in melee. They are easy to hit but can absorb significant damage. Ogres, giants, and demons are typical examples.

Strengths: Damage, HP, Regeneration, Zone Control

Weaknesses: Defense, Long-Range, Mobility

Tactics: Brutes are most dangerous in close combat. They work well alongside **Strikers** or **Tacticians**, which can distract or slow enemies, letting Brutes deal maximum damage. Brutes excel in areas that limit enemy movement, such as narrow corridors, forests, or small rooms.

Examples: A giant ogre rampaging through a village square, a demon crushing the gates of a fortress, or a hulking troll charging through dense forest to reach the PCs.

DEFENDERS

Defenders protect allies and control enemy movement. They have moderate HP and strong defenses but limited damage. Knights, bodyguards, and guardian constructs are examples.

Strengths: Close-Range, Crowd Control, Debuffs, Defense

Weaknesses: Damage, Long-Range

Tactics: Defenders excel at holding positions and shielding allies. They pair well with **Strikers** or **Leaders**. Defenders constantly reposition to stay between enemies and allies, forcing opponents into unfavorable positions.

Examples: A line of armored knights holding the bridge against the PCs, a guardian golem standing in the doorway of a treasure vault, or a squad of paladins protecting spellcasters from approaching enemies.

LEADERS

Leaders enhance allies through buffs, healing, and tactical control. They focus on coordinating the battlefield rather than solo combat. Warlords, battle clerics, and generals fit this role.

Strengths: Buffs, Debuffs, Regeneration, Zone Control

Weaknesses: Crowd Control, Evasion, Long-Range

Tactics: Leaders support allies while staying protected. They excel at applying consistent advantages, such as auras, movement boosts, or tactical repositioning. Leaders are most effective when supported by a mix of offensive and defensive roles.

Examples: A warlord directing soldiers while granting them extra attacks, a cleric inspiring allies from the rear lines, or a general coordinating elemental minions to control key areas of the battlefield.

SOLDIER

Soldiers are mobile fighters that harass enemies and control space. They can fight at range or in melee. Combatants with well-rounded abilities in offense, defense, and mobility are examples of soldiers.

Strengths: Damage, Defense, Mobility

Weaknesses: Long-Range, Zone Control

Tactics: Soldiers thrive when they can maneuver freely to hit weak targets and avoid danger. They work well alongside **Strikers**, **Brutes**, or **Leaders** that create opportunities for attacks. Ambushes, confined spaces, or multi-level terrain highlight their mobility and versatility.

Examples: Skilled mercenaries weaving through the front lines, sword and shield in hand, cutting off retreating foes. Mounted knights circling the battlefield to strike at exposed targets. Agile duelists darting between cover in city streets, countering spells and arrows with quick reflexes.

Beta Note: The Soldier role was formerly called **Skirmisher**. The name was changed due to confusion with the Lurker role.

STRIKERS

Strikers are high-damage combatants who specialize in attacking from outside the enemy's immediate reach. Whether firing from long range, emerging from concealment, or swooping in for sudden bursts of violence, Strikers rely on positioning and timing rather than durability. Archers, damage-focused spellcasters, assassins, ambush predators, and certain dragons all fall into this role.

Strengths: Damage, Positioning, Mobility, Burst

Weaknesses: Close-Range, HP, Defense, Crowd Control

Tactics: Strikers excel by attacking when and where enemies are least prepared. Some hold elevated or distant positions to rain damage from afar, while others hide in shadows or circle high above before committing to a rapid hit-and-run assault. They rarely stand their ground; instead they rely on **terrain**, **cover**, **stealth**, or **mobility** to avoid retaliation. Strikers perform best when paired with **Brutes**, **Defenders**, or **Soldiers** who can occupy the frontline, or with **Leaders** or **Tacticians** who create openings for decisive strikes. Because they often contribute a large share of a group's damage, Strikers are common priority targets for player characters.

Examples: An archer on a cliff peppering the party from long range, an assassin emerging from behind a pillar for a lethal strike before slipping away, a dragon strafing the battlefield with fire from above, or a shadowy creature firing bolts of eldritch energy from the edge of the torchlight.

Beta Note: The Striker replaced the Artillerist and Lurker roles, which both provided similar damage increases at the cost of lower HP and Defenses.



TACTICIANS

Tacticians shape the flow of battle through indirect means, such as hindering enemies, empowering allies, or influencing the terrain and conditions of a fight. They rarely rely on raw damage. Instead, they specialize in control, support, and utility that guide how engagements unfold. Spellcasters, hags, fey, healers, and other versatile casters or mystics often fall into this role.

Strengths: Crowd Control, Buffs, Debuffs, Zone Control, Cleansing

Weaknesses: Damage, Close-Range, HP, Mobility

Tactics: Tacticians are most effective when protected by tougher allies. Their abilities can slow, disable, or confuse enemies, and they can also reinforce, heal, or empower their own side. They thrive in coordinated groups and use terrain, hazards, or status effects to shift the balance of power. Pairing them with **Defenders**, **Brutes**, or **Soldiers** helps keep them safe, while **Strikers** benefit from the openings that Tacticians create. Because their abilities often alter the course of a battle, Tacticians are common priority targets for player characters.

Examples: A hag spreading poisonous mists that weaken attackers while her minions advance; a dryad bolstering woodland allies with protective enchantments; a battlefield medic cleansing curses and restoring vitality; or a fey trickster dividing the party with illusions and debilitating charms.

Beta Note: The Tactician replaced the Controller and Support roles, which both provided similar utility (Controller debuffed enemies, Support buffed allies) at the cost of lower HP and damage.

MONSTER ROLE TABLE

The table below outlines the typical stat adjustments used to tailor a monster to a specific monster role.

ROLE	HP MODIFIER	DAMAGE MODIFIER	AVERAGE DEFENSES	TRAIT VALUE	TYPES OF TRAITS
Brute	+25%	+25%	-4	-	Resistances
Defender	-	-25%	+2	-4	Crowd Control, Debuffs
Leader	-	-25%	-	4	Auras, Help, Repositioning
Soldier	-	-	-	-	Basic Combat Benefits
Striker	-25%	+50%	-2	-	Range Attack, Mobility
Tactician	-25%	-25%	-	8	Crowd Control, Zone Control, Healing

BUILDING AN ENCOUNTER

Designing a well-balanced encounter is one of the most rewarding parts of running *DC20*. A good encounter should challenge the party without overwhelming them, encourage tactical decision-making, and keep the tension high. This system uses a level-based approach that closely aligns monster levels with the levels of the player characters (PCs), helping Game Masters (GMs) create fair and exciting battles.

ENCOUNTER BUDGET

When creating a Combat Encounter, the total number of **monster levels** should generally match the **total number of PC levels** in the party. This creates a balanced, Medium difficulty Combat Encounter where both sides are near evenly matched but the party is favored to win. This guideline ensures the party faces a fair challenge without excessive risk of a total party defeat, unless luck or strategy swings heavily in one direction.

Example: A party of 4 x Level 3 PCs would have an Encounter Budget of 12 ($4 \times 3 = 12$).

ENCOUNTER DIFFICULTY

Once you know your party's total level, compare it to the combined level of the monsters to determine the difficulty of the encounter. You can increase or decrease difficulty of a Combat Encounter by adjusting the damage dealt by the monsters (see the **Monster Damage** section) or by increasing or decreasing their level or quantity as show in the table below.

DIFFICULTY	TOTAL MONSTER LEVEL
Deadly	Encounter Budget + 4x Average PC Level
Very Hard	Encounter Budget + 2x Average PC Level
Hard	Encounter Budget + Average PC Level
Medium	Encounter Budget
Easy	Encounter Budget - Average PC Level

DEGREES OF DIFFICULTY

Deadly: These Combat Encounters are designed to be truly life-threatening. A frontal assault is rarely wise; survival often depends on retreat, clever tactics, or exploiting a narrow advantage.

Very Hard: Victory demands sharp tactics, coordinated teamwork, and careful positioning. One mistake can shift the fight, and players must actively work together to turn the odds.

Hard: Clever parties can seize victory through smart play, resource management, teamwork, coordination, and sharp tactics.

Medium: The party holds a modest advantage. The threat is real enough to keep players alert, but they are expected to prevail unless they take major risks.

Easy: These encounters should feel safe while remaining interesting. The party can showcase their abilities without much danger, making them good warmups or moments of momentum.

MONSTERS LEVEL CONVERSION

The simplest way to balance an Encounter is by ensuring there are an equal number of Monsters and PCs that are of the same level. However, you can covert a Monster into multiple Monsters of lower levels, provided their total levels add up to the same value.

Example: You could convert a Level 6 Monster into 2 x Level 3 Monsters or 3 x Level 2 Monsters.

DC Tip: Monster level conversion doesn't work as well with Monsters that are Level 3 or lower. This is because a Level 2 Monster is only ~60% as strong as 2 x Level 1 Monsters (when you add their HP and damage together), so when you convert a Level 2 Monster into 2 x Level 1 Monsters you increase the danger by +75% (the danger should ideally remain the same). When using Monster level conversion on Level 2 Monsters, budget the Encounter for 1 Difficulty lower than normal. For example, you could convert 1 x Level 2 Monster of Hard difficulty to 2 x Level 1 Monsters of Medium difficulty.

ACTION ECONOMY

The **action economy** is one of the key elements that determines the difficulty of a combat encounter. It represents the total number of **Actions** a side can take in a single Round, measured by their combined **Action Points (AP)**. The relationship between the monsters' total AP and the party's total AP dictates how frequently each side can act, attack, reposition, and react to changing conditions on the battlefield.

ADJUSTING THE ACTION ECONOMY

If you want to increase or decrease the number of monsters without changing the encounter's difficulty, adjust their available AP so that the **total monster AP** remains roughly equal to the **total PC AP**. This ensures both sides have comparable opportunities to act each Round, keeping the flow of combat dynamic and fair. For more guidance on modifying a monster's AP, see the **Adjusting Action Points** section.

DYNAMIC MONSTERS

Not all encounters rely solely on the number of monsters. You can adjust the number and type of enemies using **Dynamic Monsters**. These are special monster types that change the Encounter's pacing and feel without altering the Encounter Budget.

LEGENDARY MONSTERS

Legendary monsters are threats designed to challenge an entire party on their own. They possess immense resilience and a range of abilities that make each round of combat feel cinematic and dangerous. When calculating your Encounter Budget, 1 **Legendary monster** is equal to 4 **monsters** of the same level.

LEGENDARY ADJUSTMENTS

- 4 times as much HP
- 6 Reaction Points
- Gains **Round Actions**

EPIC MONSTERS

Epic monsters serve as elite opponents that require coordination and strategy to defeat. They stand above ordinary creatures but do not reach the legendary scale. When calculating your Encounter Budget, 1 **Epic monster** is equal to 2 **monsters** of the same level.

EPIC ADJUSTMENTS

- 2 times as much HP
- 3 Reaction Points
- May have **Round Actions** (optional)

MINIONS

Minions are weak enemies that exist to create pressure, add cinematic flair, and make heroes feel powerful. They are defeated quickly, but their numbers can influence positioning and tempo in combat. When calculating your Encounter Budget, 2 **Minion monsters** are equal to 1 **monster** of the same level.

MINION ADJUSTMENTS

- 1/2 as much HP
- 2 Action Points instead of 4

DC Tip: Because movement and attacks both require AP, it is recommended that no monster have fewer than 2 AP (see **Adjusting Action Points** for more considerations).

DYNAMIC MONSTER TABLE

MONSTER TYPE	REPLACES	HP MULTIPLIER	ACTION POINTS	SPECIAL NOTES
Legendary	4 monsters	x4	4 AP + 6 Reaction Points	Has Round Actions. Major boss threat.
Epic	2 monsters	x2	4 AP + 3 Reaction Points	May have Round Actions. Elite opponent.
Standard	1 monster	x1	4 AP	Default monster type.
Minion	1/2 monster	x0.5	2 AP	Fragile, quick to defeat, adds cinematic flair.

ADVANCED ACTIONS

Epic and **Legendary** monsters gain special options that expand their tactical reach: **Round Actions** and **Reaction Points**.

Beta Note: Round Actions were formerly called Epic Actions, and Reaction Points were formerly called Legendary Action Points (LAP). They were both renamed to distinguish them from Epic and Legendary monsters respectively, and to make it clearer what function they have in the game.

ROUND ACTIONS

Round Actions make large battles feel epic and ensure powerful creatures maintain presence and pressure throughout a fight. A monster with Round Actions can automatically perform the stated Action at any time during the stated Round, unless the monster is **Incapacitated**. These Actions may be the same each Round or unique to each Round, depending on design intent. Each Round Action should be roughly equivalent to a 2 AP Action the monster could take normally.

REACTION POINTS

Reaction Points allow a monster to act more frequently outside of its own Turn, keeping the fight dynamic and unpredictable.

USING REACTION POINTS

A monster can spend Reaction Points to take Actions, Reactions, or perform AP Enhancements in the following ways:

Reactions: The monster can spend Reaction Points to take Reactions available to them.

Example: If the monster has the ability to perform a **Spell Duel**, they could spend 2 AP to challenge a Spell cast by another creature. Alternatively, they could spend 2 Reaction Points instead of 2 Action Points to perform the Spell Duel.

Actions (End of PC Turn): At the end of a PC Turn, the monster can spend Reaction Points instead of Action Points to take an Action. If an effect prevents you from taking Reactions, you can still spend Reaction Points to take Actions at the end of a PC Turn. If multiple PC's share the same PC Turn, the monster can take a number of Actions up to the number of PC's that occupy that PC Turn.

Example: If 2 PCs are sharing a Turn (see **Shared Initiative**), when their Turn ends, a monster with Reaction Points can take 2 Actions (1 Action per PC). They could take the Attack Action twice, take the Move Action then the Attack Action, or another other 2 Actions of their choice.

AP Enhancements: When the monster spends Reaction Points to take an Action or Reaction, they can spend additional Reaction Points to perform AP Enhancements with that Action or Reaction. The total amount of Action Points and Reactions Points spent on an Action or Reaction can't exceed 4.

Example: A PC just ended their Turn. The monster can spend 1 Reaction Point to take the Attack Action and make an Attack against a target within range. The monster can add any AP Enhancements to the Attack, spending an amount of Reaction Points equal to the AP cost required. The AP cost of the Attack plus the Enhancements can't exceed 4 AP, because the monster can't spend more than 4 Reaction Points per Action.

REGAINING REACTION POINTS

The monster regains all spent Reaction Points at the end of its Turn.

EXAMPLE ENCOUNTERS

A party of 4 x Level 5 PCs have an Encounter Budget of 20. Here are some example encounters the GM can create of varying difficulties.

DC Tip: Avoid using monsters that are more than 4 levels higher or lower than the party's level. A gap of more than +2 Combat Modifiers can make battles unpredictable or overly swingy.

DEADLY

Encounter Budget 40

- 1 x Level 5 Legendary monster + 2 x Level 5 Epic monster
- 4 x Level 5 Epic monster
- 8 x Level 5 monsters
- 5 x Level 8 monsters
- 16 x Level 5 Minion monsters

VERY HARD

Encounter Budget 30

- 1 x Level 5 Legendary monster + 2 x Level 5 monsters
- 2 x Level 5 Epic monster + 2 x Level 5 monsters
- 6 x Level 5 monsters
- 5 x Level 6 monsters
- 12 x Level 5 Minion monsters

HARD

Encounter Budget 25

- 1 x Level 5 Legendary monster + 1 x Level 5 monster
- 2 x Level 5 Epic monster + 1 x Level 5 monster
- 5 x Level 5 monsters
- 6 x Level 4 monsters + 1 x Level 1 monster
- 10 x Level 5 Minion monsters

MEDIUM

Encounter Budget 20

- 1 x Level 5 Legendary monster
- 2 x Level 5 Epic monster
- 4 x Level 5 monsters
- 5 x Level 4 monsters
- 8 x Level 5 Minion monsters

EASY

Encounter Budget 15

- 1 x Level 5 Epic monster + 1 Level 5 monster
- 3 x Level 5 monsters
- 5 x Level 3 monsters
- 6 x Level 5 Minion monsters

BESTIARY

ANGELIC HERALD

Description: Humanoid celestials with skin tones ranging from bronze to gold, four large, feathered wings, and shining with a bright halo, Angelic Heralds wear elegant robes with golden adornments and wield long, golden spears.

Tactics: They expose their foes with their **Radiant Aura**, then strike them with their **Spears**. When surrounded, they use Auras to control and harm their enemies. If they have an ally, they'll heal them with their **Healing Word** when they become **Bloodied** and give them Inspiration to keep fighting.

Lore: The Heralds are the first line of offense in angelic armies. They're deemed heralds, as they're always seen first when a battle of otherworldly powers begins. If a cosmic fight is to happen somewhere populated by mortals, they arrive early to warn the people and clear out the area.



ANGELIC HERALD

Medium Celestial | Level 3 Leader

HP: 19 PD: 15/20/25 AD: 15/20/25

MIG 0 (2) AGI 2 (4) CHA 3 (5) INT 0 (2)

Resistances: Radiant (2)

Vulnerabilities: Umbral (2)

Skills: Awareness +5, Acrobatics +4, Influence +7, Insight +7

Senses: Darkvision 10

Languages: All

Other Speeds: Ground 6

FEATURES

Inspire: Once per turn, give a d8 Help Die to an allied creature for free.

ACTIONS (4)

Attack: +5 Save DC: 15 Speed: Fly 8

(1) Healing Word: You heal a creature within 5 Spaces. Make a DC 15 Spell Check. **Failure:** Target regains 1 HP. **Success:** Target regains 2 HP. **Success (each 5):** +1 HP.

(1) Spear: Melee Martial Attack vs PD, 2 Spaces, 1 Piercing + 1 extra damage on Heavy Hits.

• **(+1) Guiding Strike:** Target makes a Physical Save. **Failure:** Attacks made against the target add a d4 to the Check for 1 Round.

(2) Radiant Burst: Area Spell Attack vs AD, 2 Space Aura, 1 Radiant.

(3) Divine Proclamation (MP Effect): Contest, 5 Space Aura, Spell Check vs Repeated Charisma Save. **Success:** Target is **Frightened** of you for 1 Round. **Failure:** Target is immune to this effect for 1 day.

REACTIONS

(1) Divine Grace: When another creature within 5 Spaces makes a Save, they can add a d8 bonus die to that Save.

ANIMATED ARMOR

Description: These mobile suits of armor are usually completely hollow on the inside, animated by magic that gives them a semblance of life. The types of armor they're made from vary widely, but a sturdy plate mail is the most popular and most effective.

Tactics: They control the battlefield with attacks that push targets into each other (**Mace Bash**), and then running through lines of enemies (**Pathcarver**). If they have a humanoid ally, they'll **Equip** themselves to their ally to give them extra defense. When an ally is targeted, they **Protect** them every chance they get.

Lore: An Animated Armor makes for a great guard for a location that someone wants to keep undisturbed. They're usually used by mages who make them themselves or by those who are wealthy enough to have someone make the construct for them. They're kept as resolute watchers who can guard an area at all times, attacking anyone who should pass that doesn't have clearance by their master.



ANIMATED ARMOR

Medium Construct | Level 1 Defender

HP: 10 PD: 13/18/23 AD: 9/14/19

MIG 3 (4) AGI 0 (1) CHA 1 (2) INT -2 (-1)

Reductions: PDR, EDR

Vulnerabilities: Corrosion (Double)

Immunities: Poison | **Bleeding, Exhausted, Poisoned**

Skills: Awareness +7, Athletics +5

Languages: Languages of its creator but doesn't speak

FEATURES

False Appearance: While you remain motionless, you're indistinguishable from a suit of armor.

Lost Bulk: While you're **Bloodied**, your Speed is increased by 2 and your PD and AD are reduced by 2.

ACTIONS (4)

Attack: +4 Save DC: 14 Speed: 4

(1) Mace: Melee Martial Attack vs PD, 1 Bludgeoning + 1 extra damage on a Heavy Hit.

- **(+1) Bash:** Target makes a Might Save. **Failure:** Target is pushed 1 Space away from you. **Failure (each 5):** +1 Space.

(2) Patchcarver: Area Martial Attack vs AD, 4 Space Line, 1 Bludgeoning + 1 extra damage on a Heavy Hit. After Attacking, you can move to any Space within 1 Space of the area without provoking Opportunity Attacks from the targets and without spending your movement.

(2) Equip: Equip yourself to a Medium or smaller non-Construct creature within 1 Space that isn't equipped by another Animated Armor. While equipped:

- You and the target are **Slowed**. You occupy the same Space and move together.
- The target has +2 PD and +2 AD.
- This effect ends when you or the target dies, you use **Equip** on another creature, or you spend 1 AP unequip from the target and move into an unoccupied Space adjacent to it.

REACTIONS

(1) Protect: When another creature within 1 Space is Hit by an Attack, the damage is shared between you and the target. You have Resistance (Half) to any damage you take from the Attack.

ANIMATED DOLL

Description: A beautiful porcelain doll in fine but durable clothes. It's feet gently clatter against the floor as it moves.

Tactics: They try to stay close to their owners, **Protecting** them from any harm. When possible, they **Encourage** and **Help** their owners.

Lore: Animated Dolls are frequently companions to noble children. They're created to be caring and supportive of their owner's needs, and to protect their owner should there be danger.

ANIMATED DOLL

Tiny Construct | Novice Leader

HP: 7 PD: 10/15/20 AD: 10/15/20

MIG -2 AGI -1 CHA 2 INT 0

Vulnerabilities: Bludgeoning (Double)

Immunities: Poison | **Bleeding, Exhausted, Poisoned**

Skills: Awareness +4, Influence +4, Insight +4

Languages: Languages of its creator but doesn't speak

FEATURES

False Appearance: While you remain motionless, you're indistinguishable from a doll

Helpful: Your Help Die starts at a d10.

ACTIONS (3)

Attack: +2 Save DC: 12 Speed: 4

(1) Kick: Melee Martial Attack vs PD, 1 Bludgeoning.

(1) Encourage: An adjacent creature gains +1 Temp HP.

REACTIONS

(1) Protect: When another creature within 1 Space is Hit by an Attack, the damage is shared between you and the target. You have Resistance (Half) to any damage you take from the Attack.

BANDIT

Description: Bandits are as diverse as the many cultures they come from, but all are well armed and battle worn. They frequently have scars and tattoos, and speak in gruff, terse tones.

Tactics: Focus fire on the weakest targets in range first. Will **Reckless Whirlwind** if Flanked, and will flee if heavily injured or outnumbered 2 to 1.

Lore: Bandits are hardened criminals, abandoning civilization to prey on innocent travelers. They frequently set up a base of operations, then ambush travelers on nearby roads.

BANDIT

Medium Humanoid | Level 0 Striker

HP: 9 PD: 13/18/23 AD: 11/16/21

MIG 1 (2) AGI 2 (3) CHA -2 (-1) INT 0 (1)

Skills: Awareness +6, Acrobatics +4, Stealth +6, Trickery +4

FEATURES

Cheap Shot: You deal +1 damage to creatures you're Hidden from or are Flanked, **Prone**, or subjected to at least 1 Condition other than **Invisible**.

ACTIONS (4)

Attack: +3 Save DC: 13 Speed: 5

(1) Charging Axe: Move up to your Speed, then make a Melee Martial Attack vs PD, 1 Slashing.

- **(+1) Savage Cuts:** Physical Save. **Failure:** Target begins **Bleeding**. While **Bleeding** from this, the target can't remove **Bleeding** by regaining HP.

- **(+1) Sunder:** Physical Save. **Failure:** Target gains Physical Vulnerability (1) for 1 Round.

(2) Reckless Whirlwind: Move up to your Speed, then make an Area Martial Attack vs AD, 1 Space Aura, 1 Slashing. The next Attack against you has ADV.

(2) Crossbow: Ranged Martial Attack vs PD, 15/45 Spaces, 2 Piercing.

- **(+2) Piercing Round:** The Attack becomes an Area Attack vs PD, 3 Space Line originating from the target, pointing away from you.

BANDIT CAPTAIN

Description: Bandit Captains are as diverse as the many cultures they come from, but all well armed and battle worn. They frequently have more scars and tattoos than their fellow bandits and are frequently larger with commanding tones.

Tactics: Uses **Rally** and **Help** to support allies, then flank an enemy to attack. Uses **Acid Vial** if it can hit at least 2 enemies without hitting allies.

Lore: Bandit Captains lead a group of hardened criminals, abandoning civilization to prey on innocent travelers. They frequently set up a base of operations, then ambush travelers on nearby roads.

BANDIT CAPTAIN

Medium Humanoid | Level 1 Leader

HP: 11 PD: 10/15/20 AD: 13/18/23

MIG 1 (2) AGI -1 (0) CHA 3 (4) INT 0 (1)

Skills: Awareness +5, Athletics +3, Influence +5

FEATURES

Inspiring Aura (5 Space Aura): Other creatures of your choice within the Aura have ADV on Saves against **Intimidated**.

Rally: At the start of your turn, other creatures of your choice within a 5 Space Aura gain +1 Temp HP.

ACTIONS (4)

Attack: +4 Save DC: 14 Speed: 5

(1) Help: You take the Help Action with a range of 5 Spaces.

(1) Axe: Melee Martial Attack vs PD, 1 Slashing.

- **(+1) Bleed:** Repeated Physical Save. **Failure:** Target is **Bleeding**.

- **(+1) Order Attack:** An allied creature within 1 Space of the target makes an Opportunity Attack against the target.

(2) Acid Vial: Area Martial Attack vs AD, 10 Spaces, 3 Space Sphere, 1 Corrosion.

- **(+1) Hinder:** Agility Save. **Failure:** Target becomes **Hindered** for 1 Round.

REACTIONS

(1) Undermine: When a creature within 1 Space of you misses with a Melee Attack, you can force the attacker to make an Agility Save. **Failure:** Target is knocked **Prone**.

BROWN BEAR

Description: A massive beast with brown fur covering a thick hide and a loud roar warning of imminent combat.

Tactics: When surrounded, they'll **Roar** to intimidate creatures around them. Otherwise, they'll attack any creature that has hurt them most or seems weakest, using **Swipe** Attacks when their enemies are close to each other.

Lore: These piles of muscle and teeth typically travel alone or in pairs. While usually peaceful, they're incredibly territorial and dangerous when provoked or hungry.

BROWN BEAR

Large Beast | Level 2 Brute

HP: 17 PD: 9/14/19 AD: 11/16/21

MIG 3 (4) AGI 1 (2) CHA 0 (1) INT -3 (-2)

Skills: Awareness +5, Athletics +7, Survival +3

FEATURES

Keen Smell: You have ADV on Awareness Checks made to smell.

ACTIONS (4)

Attack: +4 Save DC: 14 Speed: 6

(1) Bite or Claw: Melee Martial Attack vs PD, 2 Slashing or Piercing + 1 extra damage on a Heavy Hit.

- **(+1) Grapple:** Might Save. **Failure:** Target is **Grappled**.

- **(+1) Prone:** Physical Save. **Failure:** Target is knocked **Prone**.

(2) Swipe: Area Martial Attack vs AD, 1 Space Arc, 2 Slashing and target makes a Physical Save. **Failure:** Target is **Bleeding**.

- **(+1) Knockback:** Might Save. **Failure:** Target is pushed 1 Space away.

(2) Intimidating Roar: Contest, 5 Space Aura (creatures of your choice), Intimidation vs Charisma Save. **Success:** Target is **Intimidated** by you for 1 Round.

REACTIONS

(1) Chase: When you make an Opportunity Attack against a creature leaving your Melee range, you can move up to your Speed following the creature and make another Opportunity Attack at the end of your movement.

CHERUB

Description: This small angel appears as the ancestry of whoever is viewing it without changing its size, showing itself as the picture of preciousness to the viewer. Their vocal mannerisms emulate the sound of children.

Tactics: Cherubs try to avoid combat, but when they find themselves in a fight, they try to attack from range, using arrows (**Cupid Arrow**) and charming magic (**Provoke Insecurities**). To avoid being hurt, they try to Charm their enemies (see **Cupid Arrow's Charm** Enhancement and **Reactive Charm**).

Lore: Cherubs are servants to greater Celestials. They enjoy helping people find love, but rarely ask, and are commonly blamed for the actions of unfaithful partners.

CHERUB

Small Celestial | Level 0 Tactician

HP: 8 PD: 12/17/22 AD: 10/15/20

MIG -2 (-1) AGI 2 (3) CHA 2 (3) INT 1 (2)

Resistances: Radiant (1)

Vulnerabilities: Umbral (1)

Skills: Awareness +4, Influence +4, Insight +4

Senses: Darkvision 10

Languages: Celestial

Other Speeds: Ground 4

ACTIONS (4)

Attack: +3 Save DC: 15 Speed: Fly 8

(1) **Cupid Arrow:** Ranged Martial Attack vs PD, 15/45 Spaces, 1 Piercing.

- (+1) **Charm:** Target makes a Charisma Save. **Failure:** Target is **Charmed** by a creature of your choice for 1 minute or until that creature Attacks them or forces them to make a Save.

(1) **Provoke Insecurities:** [**Charmed** creature], Ranged Spell Attack vs AD, 10 Spaces, 1 Psychic and target makes a Mental Save. **Failure:** Target subtracts a **d4** on every Check it makes for 1 Round.

REACTIONS

(1) **Reactive Charm:** When you're Attacked, you force the Attacker to make a Charisma Save. **Failure:** Target is **Charmed** by you for 1 minute or until you Attack them or force them to make a Save.

EARTH TORTOISE

Description: A huge turtle with a stone shell and skin. Its slow, steady steps shake the ground around it.

Tactics: It **Slams** enemies **Prone** then **Stomps** on them. If it's surrounded, it attacks everyone near it in a **Rampage**. When it receives a Heavy Hit, it'll **Endure** it and try to reduce the damage taken.

Lore: Earth tortoises are usually found near crags or mountains. They're territorial, quick to protect their land against perceived external threats.

EARTH TORTOISE

Huge Elemental | Level 5 Defender

HP: 30 PD: 14/19/24 AD: 20/25/30

MIG 4 (7) AGI -2 (1) CHA 3 (6) INT -1 (2)

Reductions: PDR, EDR

Vulnerabilities: Bludgeoning (Double)

Immunities: Poison | **Bleeding, Burning, Poisoned, Slowed**

Skills: Awareness +4, Athletics +8

ACTIONS (4)

Attack: +7 Save DC: 17 Speed: 3

(1) **Slam:** Melee Martial Attack vs PD, 1 Bludgeoning + 1 extra damage on a Heavy Hit and target makes a Physical Save. **Failure:** Target falls **Prone**.

(1) **Stomp:** [**Prone** creature], Melee Martial Attack vs AD, 3 Bludgeoning + 1 extra damage on a Heavy Hit.

(2) **Rampage:** Area Martial Attack vs AD, 1 Space Aura, 1 Bludgeoning + 1 extra damage if the target is **Prone** and target must make a Physical Save. **Failure:** Target falls **Prone**.

REACTIONS

(1) **Endure:** When you are Hit by an Attack, you can take 3 less damage from the Attack.

FAIRY DRAGON

Description: A small species of dragon with a lithe body, iridescent scales, and butterfly wings that rapidly flutter to keep it aloft. It gives off the scent of fresh flowers.

Tactics: Able to create illusions, Fairy Dragons start off Combat by making a copy of themselves (**Illusory Duplicate**) to trick foes into attacking their copy. During a fight, they'll use **Mockery** on their enemies, try to put them to sleep (**Slumber**), and they'll **Vanish** when hit by an Attack, turning themselves Invisible for a short time.

Lore: Fairy Dragons act as sentries, typically stationed near entrances to the fey realms and reporting any crossings that occur. They like to play pranks on passersby, frequently teaming up with pixies or sprites.

FAIRY DRAGON

Tiny Dragon | Level 1 Tactician

HP: 15

PD: 16/21/26

AD: 21/26/31

MIG -2 (-1)

AGI 2 (3)

CHA 3 (4)

INT 1 (2)

Skills: Awareness +4, Acrobatics +4, Stealth +6, Trickery +6, Influence +5

Senses: Truesight 10

Languages: Draconic, Fey

Other Speeds: Ground 5

FEATURES

Tricky Start: At the start of Combat, you may use Illusory Split and move up to your Speed.

ACTIONS (4)

Attack: +4

Save DC: 14

Speed: Fly 5

(1) Mockery: Ranged Spell Attack vs AD, 10 Spaces, 1 Psychic.

- **(+1) Taunt:** Target makes a Charisma Save. **Failure:** Target is **Taunted** by you for 1 Round.

(1) Illusory Split: You create an illusion of yourself in your Space. The illusion has your mannerisms but can't Attack or affect the world physically. It lasts for 1 minute, until you use this ability again, or you end your turn more than 10 Spaces away from the illusion.

- When you move, you can move the illusion up to that many Spaces in any direction.
- Attacking the illusion reveals it to be an illusion. A creature can also spend **1 AP** to make an Investigation Check against your Save DC. **Success:** The creature knows it's an illusion.

(2) Slumber (MP Effect): Contest, 10 Spaces, 3 Space Sphere, Spell Check vs Repeated Intelligence Save. **Success:** The target is **Incapacitated** for 1 minute or until it takes damage, makes a Save (other than from this effect), or another creature within 1 Space spends **1 AP** to remove the condition.

REACTIONS

(1) Vanish: When you're Hit by an Attack, you can become **Invisible** for 1 Round or until you take any Action besides the Move, Dodge, or Hide Actions.

FIENDISH HARBINGER

Description: Humanoid fiends with skin tones ranging from yellow to red, goat horns and hind legs, and a snake tail, Fiendish Harbingers wield long, black tridents engraved with depictions of faces screaming in pain.

Tactics: They use their Trident and Umbral magic (see **Umbral Burst**) to hurt their enemies, and Doom anyone who heals near them (see **Foretell Demise**). They'll usually begin Combat with an **Infernal Declaration**, Dooming anyone near them.

Lore: Harbingers make up the vanguard of fiendish armies, striking first and fast. These fiends usually try to arrive before celestial armies can, taking mortal hostages and causing widespread panic in populated areas to lower the morale of their holy counterparts. The first sighting of a Fiendish Harbinger is a sign that death and destruction is on its way.

FIENDISH HARBINGER

Medium Fiend | Level 3 Soldier

HP: 19 PD: 15/20/25 AD: 15/20/25

MIG 0 (2) AGI 2 (4) CHA 3 (5) INT 0 (2)

Resistances: Umbral (2)

Vulnerabilities: Radiant (2)

Skills: Awareness +5, Acrobatics +6, Influence +7, Insight +7

Senses: Darkvision 10

Languages: All

FEATURES

Spy: Opportunity Attacks against you have DisADV and you have ADV on Checks to avoid or escape Grapples.

ACTIONS (4)

Attack: +5 Save DC: 15 Speed: 8

(1) **Doom:** Contest, 5 Spaces, Spell Check vs Charisma Save. **Failure:** Target is **Doomed**.

(1) **Trident:** Melee Martial Attack vs PD, 2 Spaces, 2 Piercing.

- **(+1) Cursed Strike:** Target makes a Repeated Charisma Save. **Failure:** Target subtracts a d4 from all its Checks for 1 minute.

(2) **Umbral Burst:** Area Spell Attack vs AD, 2 Space Aura, 1 Umbral + 1 extra damage on Heavy Hits.

(3) **Infernal Declaration (MP Effect):** Contest, 5 Space Aura, Spell Check vs Charisma Save. **Success:** Target is **Doomed**. **Failure:** Target is immune to this effect for 1 day.

REACTIONS

(1) **Foretell Demise:** When a creature within 5 Spaces of you regains HP, you can use **Doom** on them as a Reaction.

FIRE LIZARD

Description: A large, muscular lizard with cooling lava skin and a long, burning tongue. Embers constantly rise from its surface, and its eyes glow yellow. The air near it swelters with its heat.

Tactics: Fire Lizards have long **Flame Tongues** they use to grab enemies, then they retract it to pull an enemy closer (see **Retract Tongue**). When an enemy is right next to them, they'll **Bite** them. They use **Fire Breath** or **Tail Whips** to hit grouped enemies.

Lore: Fire lizards live near volcanoes and deep within caves near magma flows, eating anything that can be burned as a fuel source. They're popular in menageries and performances.

FIRE LIZARD

Medium Elemental | Level 2 Soldier

HP: 15

PD: 11/16/21

AD: 13/18/23

MIG 3 (4)

AGI 3 (4)

CHA 1 (2)

INT -3 (-2)

Vulnerabilities: Cold (Double)

Immunities: Fire (Absorb)

Skills: Awareness +3, Athletics +5, Acrobatics +5

FEATURES

Burning Hide: A creature that touches you for the first time on a turn or starts its turn touching you takes 1 Fire damage.

Flame-Blooded: When you take Cold damage or make contact with water, you become **Slowed** for 1 Round.

Glowing: You shed Bright Light in a 1 Space Aura.

Wallwalk: You can walk normally on solid surfaces regardless of their orientation (such as upside down on the ceiling) without falling or needing to Climb.

ACTIONS (4)

Attack: +4

Save DC: 14

Speed: 5

(1) Flame Tongue: Melee Martial Attack vs PD, 5 Spaces, 1 Fire and target makes a Physical Save. **Failure:** Target is **Tethered** to you until you use this Attack again or choose to end the effect. The target can spend 1 AP to repeat this Save.

(1) Retract Tongue: [Creature **Tethered** by **Flame Tongue**] Contest, Martial Check vs Might Save. **Success:** Target is pulled up to 4 Spaces towards you. The **Flame Tongue's Tether** distance is reduced by the Spaces pulled.

(1) Bite: Melee Martial Attack vs PD, 1 Fire + 1 extra damage on a Heavy Hit.

(2) Fire Breath: Area Spell Attack vs AD, 3 Space Cone, 1 Fire.

(2) Tail Whip: Contest, 1 Space Arc, Martial Check vs Physical Save. **Success:** Target is pushed up to 1 Space away from you and falls **Prone**.

GHOST

Description: A translucent humanoid form floating in the air as if submerged in water, with a haunting, hollow face with black voids for eyes. A distinct chill lingers in the air around it, noticeably colder than is natural.

Tactics: Usually, Ghosts won't attack outright. When threatened or angered, they try to get the drop on enemies with their **Ethereal** movement. If they can, they'll try to grab an enemy (**Chilling Grasp**) and **Drag** them away from their allies. When surrounded, they'll use their **Haunting Scream** to Frighten everyone around them.

Lore: Ghosts are spiritual imprints of people who died tragically or while filled with extreme negative emotions. They linger around their place of death or other places important to them in life.

GHOST VARIANTS

Modify the stat block in the following ways to make different variants:

POSSESSOR

Loses **Haunting Scream** and gains new **Possession** Action:

(4) Possession: Move to the Space of a creature within 10 Spaces and attempt to possess them. Contest, Spell Check vs Repeated Charisma Save. Failure: Target is possessed by you (considered a Curse) for 1 minute. While Possessed:

- The target is **Incapacitated** and loses control of its body.
- You control the target, using its statistics.
- You're within the target (Hidden and in Full Cover) and don't take damage from **Ethereal**.
- The possession ends early if the target drops to **0 HP**, you end it for free, or the Curse is removed.

POLTERGEIST

New Feature:

Close Quarters: Your Ranged Attacks don't have DisADV if you're within Melee Range of enemies.

Loses **Chilling Grasp** and **Haunting Scream**, but gains new **Invisibility** and **Throw Object** Actions:

(1) Invisibility: You become Invisible for 1 Round or until you take any Action besides the Move, Dodge, or Hide Actions.

(1) Throw Object: Ranged Martial Attack vs AD, 10 Spaces, 2 Bludgeoning.

- **(+1) Extra Target:** Target an additional creature within range.

GHOST

Medium Undead | Level 2 Tactician

HP: 8 PD: **13/18/23** AD: **9/14/19**

MIG **-2 (-1)** AGI **3 (4)** CHA **0 (1)** INT **0 (1)**

Resistances: Bludgeoning (Half), Piercing (Half), Slashing (Half), Umbral (Half)

Vulnerabilities: Fire (Double), Radiant (Double)

Immunities: Poison | **Bleeding, Exhausted, Grappled, Poisoned, Unconscious**

Skills: Awareness +3, Stealth +7

Senses: Darkvision 10

Languages: Languages you knew in life

FEATURES

Ethereal: You can move through solid objects and creatures. If you end your turn inside an object or creature, you take True damage equal to 25% of your maximum HP.

ACTIONS (4)

Attack: **+4** Save DC: **14** Speed: **Fly 5**

(1) Ghastly Touch: Melee Spell Attack vs PD, 1 Umbral and target makes a Physical Save. **Failure:** Target is **Slowed** for 1 Round.

(2) Chilling Grasp: Melee Spell Attack vs AD, 1 Umbral and target makes a Might Save. **Failure:** Target is **Stunned 1** and **Immobilized** for 1 Round.

- **(+1) Drag:** You move up to your Speed after, pulling the target with you if they failed their Save. You don't provoke Opportunity Attacks and can't Fly upward during this movement.

(4) Haunting Scream: Area Spell Attack vs AD, 3 Space Aura, 1 Psychic and target makes a Charisma Save. **Failure:** Target is **Frightened** by you for 1 Round.

HONEY OOZE

Description: A bright, golden blob of sticky honey, it smells sweet and makes slurping noises as its body slinks around.

Tactics: This Ooze sticks close to the territory of its beehive and **Slams** and **Absorbs** any attacker it comes across. When it **Absorbs** multiple creatures, it'll **Compress** them to try to squish their bodies. When hit by Melee Attacks, it can absorb the weapon, or creature, that struck it (see **Absorb Weapon** and **Absorb Creature**).

Lore: Honey oozes are created by Queen Dire Bees to help protect their hive, holding enemies in place while the workers and queen attack.

HONEY OOZE

Large Ooze | Novice Brute

HP: 7

PD: 6/11/16

AD: 3/8/13

MIG 2

AGI -2

CHA 0

INT -3

Resistances: Physical (1)

Immunities: Bleeding, Charmed, Deafened, Grappled, Prone, Restrained

Skills: Awareness +2, Athletics +6

Senses: Blindsight 10 (can't see beyond this)

Other Speeds: Climb 4

FEATURES

Amorphous: You're unaffected by mundane Difficult Terrain and can move through a Space as narrow as 1 inch wide without squeezing.

Anaerobic: You don't need to breathe. You're immune to hazardous air and Suffocating.

Ooze Climb: You can Climb any solid surface without making a Check.

ACTIONS (3)

Attack: +2

Save DC: 12

Speed: 4

(1) Slap: Melee Martial Attack vs PD, 1 Bludgeoning.

• **(+1) Absorb:** Might Save. **Failure:** Target is **Grappled** by you and pulled into your Space. While **Grappled**, the target is also **Restrained**.

(2) Compress: [All **Absorbed** targets] Area Martial Attack vs AD, 1 Bludgeoning.

REACTIONS

(1) Absorb Weapon: When you're Hit by a Melee Attack, you can attempt to absorb the Weapon. Contest, Martial Check vs Might Save. **Success:** The Attacker is Disarmed, and the Weapon is pulled into your Space until you drop to 0 HP.

(1) Absorb Creature: When you're Hit by a Melee Attack using a Natural Weapon or Unarmed Strike, you can attempt to absorb the Attacker. Contest, Martial Check vs Might Save. **Success:** The Attacker is **Grappled** by you and pulled into your Space. While **Grappled**, the target is also **Restrained**.

ICE RAVEN

Description: A large raven, nearly the size of a person, with white ice feathers, icicle beak and talons, and chilling blue eyes that glow. Each beat of its wings creates gusts of frigid air.

Tactics: They try to stay in the sky, attacking **Frozen Gusts** and **Frozen Torrents** to move enemies around the battlefield. If they close in on an enemy, they Peck them and Frostbite them to make them vulnerable. If Attacked, they use their aerial prowess to get out of the way (see **Evasive Flying**).

Lore: Ice Ravens live in tundras, but sometimes venture into surrounding areas. Blizzards are formed when a flock of Ice Ravens congregates. They're known for their intelligence, and many peoples from frigid lands seek allyship with the Ice Ravens by leaving them offerings.

ICE RAVEN

Medium Elemental | Level 3 Striker

HP: 14 PD: 14/19/24 AD: 10/15/20

MIG 0 (2) AGI 3 (5) CHA 0 (2) INT 2 (4)

Vulnerabilities: Fire (Double)

Immunities: Cold (Absorb)

Skills: Awareness +5, Investigation +4, Stealth +5, Trickery +7

Other Speeds: Ground 2

ACTIONS (4)

Attack: +5 Save DC: 15 Speed: Fly 5

(1) **Peck:** Melee Martial Attack vs PD, 2 Piercing + 1 extra damage on a Heavy Hit.

- (+1) **Frostbite:** Target makes a Physical Save. **Failure:** Target is **Slowed** and gains Vulnerability (Double) to the next instance of Physical or Cold damage it takes until the start of your next turn.

(1) **Frozen Gust:** Ranges Spell Attack vs PD, 10 Spaces, 1 Cold and target makes a Might Save. **Failure:** Target is pushed 1 Space horizontally in any direction. **Failure (each 5):** +1 Space.

(2) **Frozen Torrent:** Area Spell Attack vs AD, 10 Spaces, 3 Space Sphere, 1 Cold and target makes a Might Save. **Failure:** Target is moved to an unoccupied Space of your choice within the area.

REACTIONS

(1) **Evasive Flying:** When you're targeted by an Attack, you can impose DisADV on the Attack and gain ADV on any Saves imposed by the Attack.

IMP

Description: Coming in a variety of colors, imps are small humanoid Fiends with leathery wings, sharp claws, and pointed tails.

Tactics: Imps know that they're frail, so they try to keep to the air when in a fight. If an enemy gets too close, they'll **Claw** them and attempt to make them Bleed, then **Fire Warp** away. While flying, they'll lob **Fireballs** from a distance, then retreat to safety if they can.

Lore: An Imp is the lowest form of Devil. They act as servants for creatures more powerful than them, especially other Devils. Their relatively low power to other Fiends makes them easy to summon, making them an attractive option for a Familiar as well. Because of their status as the lowest form of Devil, they have an innate desire to serve a master, attaching themselves to a being who can protect them.

IMP

Small Fiend | Level 0 Striker

HP: 7 PD: 13/18/23 AD: 10/15/20

MIG -2 (-1) AGI 3 (4) CHA 1 (2) INT 0 (1)

Resistances: Fire (1)

Skills: Awareness +3, Influence +3, Stealth +5, Trickery +5

Senses: Darkvision 10

Languages: Fiend

Other Speeds: Ground 3

ACTIONS (4)

Attack: +3 Save DC: 13 Speed: Fly 5

(1) **Claw:** Melee Martial Attack vs PD, 1 Piercing + 1 extra damage on Heavy Hits.

- (+1) **Bleed:** Repeated Might Save. **Failure:** Target is **Bleeding**.

(2) **Fireball:** Area Spell Attack vs AD, 5 Spaces, 2 Space Sphere, 1 Fire + 1 extra damage on Heavy Hits.

- (+1) **Area:** The area becomes a 3 Space Sphere.

- (+1) **Burning:** Physical Save. **Failure:** Target begins **Burning**.

(2) **Fire Warp:** Area Spell Attack vs AD, 1 Space Aura, 1 Fire. Teleport to an unoccupied Space within 5 Spaces.

JUVENILE PURPLE DRAKE

Description: Brutish with gleaming purple scales and a long neck and tail, Purple Drakes are a frightening sight. Their arms and legs are thick with muscle, and they have a wide jaw with large, jagged teeth.

Tactics: Purple Drakes are fiercely protective, staying near whoever they wish to protect in a fight. If they have multiple enemies in front of them, they'll use their **Plasma Breath** to hit as many as possible. If they're surrounded, and have an ally to protect, they'll try to **Mass Taunt** their enemies with ferocious growls and swiping claws.

Lore: A Juvenile Purple Drake is a lesser dragon, that has an innate drive to protect. They usually form a strong bond to another creature, and fight with ferocity to keep that creature safe against all threats. They become dangerous when bonded with someone lacking moral character, who utilize the drake for nefarious ends.

JUVENILE PURPLE DRAKE

Large Dragon | Level 4 Defender

HP: 20 PD: 11/16/21 AD: 15/20/25

MIG 3 (5) AGI -1 (1) CHA 2 (4) INT 1 (3)

Reductions: PDR, EDR

Skills: Awareness +5, Athletics +7, Influence +6

Senses: Darkvision 10

ACTIONS (4)

Attack: +5 Save DC: 15 Speed: 6

(1) **Claw:** Melee Martial Attack vs PD, 2 Slashing + 1 extra damage on a Heavy Hit.

(2) **Plasma Breath:** Area Spell Attack vs AD, 3 Space Cone, 2 Radiant.

- **(+1) Area:** The area becomes a 5 Space Cone.
- **(+1) Concussive Breath:** Physical Save. **Failure:** Target is knocked back 1 Space. **Failure (each 5):** +1 Space.

(2) **Mass Taunt:** Contest, 5 Space Aura (creatures of your choice), Influence vs Repeated Charisma Save. **Success:** Target is **Taunted** by you for 1 minute.

REACTIONS

(1) **Fierce Protector:** When a creature within 1 Space of you makes an Attack against an ally you can see, you can make a **Claw** Attack against them.

(1) **Draconic Shield:** When a **Bloodied** creature within 10 Spaces is Attacked, they gain a +5 bonus to their PD and AD against this Attack. If they are **Well-Bloodied**, the bonus lasts for 1 Round. This effect can't stack.

MANDRAKE

Description: Its body is made up of a bunch of roots vaguely in a humanoid shape, with a head that resembles a vegetable or fruit with two oval eyes and a mouth of sharp teeth.

Tactics: Mandrakes usually try to flee from any perceived danger, singing or shrieking all the while (see **Shriek** and **Sing**; they use 1 option each round). If someone grabs one, they'll **Bite** them until their pursuer lets go.

Lore: Mandrakes are frustrating nuisances when they make their home within farms or gardens, due to their mischievous nature, but their bodies are useful ingredients in many potions.

MANDRAKE

Tiny Plant | Novice Tactician

HP: 15 PD: 16/21/26 AD: 21/26/31

MIG -2 AGI 0 CHA 2 INT -2

Vulnerabilities: Fire (Double), Slashing (Double)

Immunities: Bleeding

Skills: Awareness +2

Other Speeds: Burrow 4

FEATURES

False Appearance: While motionless, you're indistinguishable from a mundane plant.

ACTIONS (3)

Attack: +2 Save DC: 12 Speed: 4

(1) **Bite:** Melee Martial Attack vs PD, 1 Piercing.

(2) **Shriek:** Area Spell Attack vs AD, 2 Space Aura, 1 Psychic and target makes an Intelligence Save. **Failure:** Target is **Dazed** for 1 Round.

(2) **Song:** Contest, 2 Space Aura, Spell Check vs Charisma Save. **Failure:** Target is **Charmed** by you for 1 Round. Creatures of your choice in the area get a **d4** Inspiration Die that they can use on any Check or Save until the end of their next turn.

MANTICORE

Description: A powerful beast with a lion's body, a humanoid face, the wings of a dragon, and a long tail covered in green tipped spines. Its multiple rows of sharp teeth are displayed when it snarls and yowls.

Tactics: Manticores sneak up on their prey and then **Pounce** (see **Bite**) from their hiding spot when close to their target. Once they've caught a creature in their jaws (see **Bite**), they'll **Chew** them with their rows of teeth. While eating one creature, they use their **Stinger** to ward off other enemies.

Lore: Manticores are intelligent beasts that dwell in dungeons, ruins, and other locations that draw adventurers, whom they hunt and eat. They'll occasionally attack caravans or other travelers if they're sure they won't be discovered and subsequently hunted. While they can speak, they don't usually make it a habit to interact cordially with other creatures.

MANTICORE

Large Beast | Level 6 Tactician

HP: 19 PD: 16/21/26 AD: 14/19/24

MIG 4 (7) AGI 3 (6) CHA -1 (2) INT 3 (6)

Skills: Awareness +8, Athletics +10, Intimidation +10, Investigation +7, Stealth +7

Other Speeds: Fly 8

FEATURES

Keen Smell: ADV on Awareness Checks using smell.

ACTIONS (4)

Attack: +7 Save DC: 17 Speed: 8

(1) Bite: Melee Martial Attack vs PD, 3 Piercing and target makes a Physical Save. **Failure:** Target is **Grappled** until you use **Bite** again.

- **(+1) Pounce:** You can move up to your Speed before Attacking. If the target fails their Save, they also fall **Prone**.

(1) Chew: [Target **Grappled** with your **Bite**] Melee Martial Attack vs AD, 5 Piercing.

(2) Stinger: Melee or Ranged Martial Attack vs PD, 2 or 15/45 Spaces, 5 Piercing and target makes a Repeated Might Save. **Failure:** Target is **Impaired** for 1 minute (considered a Basic Poison).

REACTIONS

(Auto) Vicious Hold: When a creature makes a Check to escape your **Bite's Grapple**, you can use **Chew** for free before the Check.

MANTRAP BLOOM

Description: A beautiful flower whose meaty petals snap around prey that approach. The petals resemble a tooth-filled mouth when attacking prey. It moves by using its thick, snaking vines to drag its body across surfaces.

Tactics: Mantrap Blooms wait for prey to approach, appearing mundane with their **False Appearance**. When a creature is close enough, it **Vine Whips** them to pull them in and **Devours** them. While eating a creature, it **Digests** them quickly for sustenance. While surrounded, it may release its **Charming Pollen** to stay safe while it eats. They almost never focus their attacks on **Constructs**, **Elementals**, or **Plants**, seeking to eat creatures made of flesh and bone first.

Lore: Found in jungles, Mantrap Blooms lure and ambush prey, devouring them for added nutrients. Its nectar is used in some enchantment rituals and potions.

MANTRAP BLOOM

Large Plant | Level 1 Striker

HP: 10 PD: 10/15/20 AD: 16/21/26

MIG 3 (4) AGI -2 (-1) CHA 3 (4) INT -2 (-1)

Vulnerabilities: Fire (1), Slashing (1)

Immunities: Bleeding, Blinded

Skills: Awareness +7, Athletics +7

Other Speeds: Climb 3

FEATURES

False Appearance: While motionless, you're indistinguishable from a mundane plant.

ACTIONS (4)

Attack: +4 Save DC: 14 Speed: 3

(1) Vine Whip: Melee Martial Attack vs PD, 5 Spaces, 1 Slashing and target makes a Physical Save. **Failure:** Target is **Tethered** to you until you choose to end the effect. The target can spend 1 AP to repeat this Save.

(1) Devour: [Creature **Tethered** by **Vine Whip**] Contest, Martial Check vs Might Save. **Success:** Target is pulled into your Space and Consumed. You can't use this Attack while you have a creature Consumed.

- **While Consumed:** It's **Restrained** and takes 1 Corrosion damage at the end of its turns.

- **Escape:** Each time you lose 5 or more HP, you must make a **DC 15** Might Save. **Failure:** The target is released into an adjacent Space and is no longer **Restrained**.

(1) Digest: [Consumed creature]: Melee Martial Attack vs AD, 1 Corrosion. You regain HP equal to half the damage dealt.

(4) Charming Pollen (MP Effect): [Breathing creatures only] Contest, 5 Space Aura, Spell Check vs Repeated Charisma Save. **Failure:** Target is **Charmed** by you for 1 minute or until you Attack them or forces them to make a Save (other than from this effect).

MOLTEN GLASS OOZE

Description: This smooth, clear ooze flows like water as it moves. It is incredibly hot to the touch but only radiates heat when agitated.

Tactics: These oozes blend in with mundane glass, staying completely still to use their **False Appearance** to attack with Surprise. They'll **Slam** into enemies and then **Slather** them to Burn them. If they can't hit an enemy, they'll **Radiate Heat** to hurt them instead. When hit by a Melee Attack, they're able to splash onto their enemies to Burn them (see **Molten Splash**). These oozes are afraid of the cold, however, as it causes them to become extremely fragile and renders their Burns useless.

Lore: Molten Glass Ooze were first created to guard display cases protecting valuable treasures. The residue of their molten glass bodies stick to any would be thieves, causing serious burns and allowing authorities to magically track them.

MOLTEN GLASS OOZE

Small Ooze | Level 4 Striker

HP: 11

PD: 12/17/22

AD: 12/17/22

MIG 0 (2)

AGI 3 (5)

CHA 0 (2)

INT -3 (-1)

Resistances: Physical (1)

Vulnerabilities: Cold (Double)

Immunities: Fire | **Bleeding, Charmed, Deafened, Grappled, Prone, Restrained**

Skills: Awareness +3, Stealth +7

Senses: Blindsight 10 (can't see beyond this)

Other Speeds: Climb 5

FEATURES

False Appearance: While motionless, you're indistinguishable from glass.

Amorphous: You're unaffected by mundane Difficult Terrain and can move through a Space as narrow as 1 inch wide without squeezing.

Anaerobic: You don't need to breathe. You're immune to hazardous air and Suffocating.

Ooze Climb: You can Climb any solid surface without making a Check.

Molten Glass Body: When you take Cold damage, you lose Physical Resistance (1), gain Bludgeoning Vulnerability (Double), and become **Slowed** for 1 Round.

ACTIONS (4)

Attack: +5

Save DC: 15

Speed: 5

(1) Slam: Melee Martial Attack vs PD, 3 Fire.

- **(+2) Slather:** Agility Save. **Failure:** Target begins **Burning** for 1 minute. This **Burning** can't be removed by spending AP, but ends if the target takes Cold damage.

(2) Radiate Heat: Area Spell Attack vs AD, 1 Space Aura, 2 Fire + 1 extra damage on a Heavy Hit.

REACTIONS

(1) Molten Splash: When you're Hit by a Melee Attack, the Attacker must make an Agility Save. **Failure:** Target begins **Burning** for 1 minute. This **Burning** can't be removed by spending AP, but ends if the target takes Cold damage.

OGRE WARRIOR

Description: A giant with a thick, muscular body and a disproportionately small head with boar like tusks. Ogre Warriors typically wield massive, heavy weapons and wear thick hide armor.

Tactics: Ogre Warriors are very easy to fool, but they have strong instincts in battle. They focus attacks on weak targets first and throw spears (see **Spear Throw**) at distant enemies. If they're surrounded, they'll stomp the ground (see **Ground Stomp**) and attack anyone who falls over from the quaking earth. They're also keen on protecting their allies, and loose a **Taunting Bellow** to distract enemies when needed.

Lore: Ogres utilize their size to hunt large animals. Ogre Warriors tend to be the least intelligent of their kind, being good for little more than fighting.

OGRE WARRIOR

Large Giant | Level 2 Brute

HP: 29 PD: 8/13/18 AD: 12/17/22

MIG 3 (4) AGI 1 (2) CHA 0 (1) INT -2 (-1)

Skills: Awareness +3, Athletics +7, Intimidation +7

ACTIONS (4)

Attack: +4 Save DC: 14 Speed: 5

(1) Maul: Melee Martial Attack vs PD, 2 Spaces 1 Bludgeoning + **1 extra damage** if the target is **Prone** and target makes a Physical Save. **Failure:** Target falls **Prone**.

(2) Spear Throw: Area Martial Attack vs AD, 10 Space Line, 1 Piercing.

• **(+1) Slow:** Target makes a Repeated Physical Save. **Failure:** Target is **Slowed** for 1 minute.

(2) Ground Stomp: [Medium or smaller creatures] Contest, 2 Space Aura, Martial Check vs Physical Save. **Success:** Target falls **Prone**.

(2) Taunting Bellow: Contest, 5 Space Aura, Martial Check vs Repeated Charisma Save. **Success:** Target is **Taunted** by you for 1 minute.

PIXIE

Description: Feral fey with a humanoid body, but bestial features. Pixies can have the features of any animal, with claws, antennae, bird or bug wings, black eyes, etc. Some can even have fur or the lower body of an animal or insect. Golden dust falls off of its body as it flies.

Tactics: These little fey like to stick together in small packs and aren't usually directly violent unless provoked. When angered, they'll swarm their enemies and try to surround them and **Claw** them while moving in and out of danger and set 1 or 2 of their ranks to hide and mock (**Vicious Mockery**) the enemies from afar. If there's a particularly big threat, they'll attempt to put them into a magical **Slumber** to get away.

Lore: Pixies have little intelligence and act almost like wild animals, with a hint of mischievousness. The golden dust that coats their bodies is imbued with fey magic, causing some poachers to hunt them for its alchemical properties.

PIXIE

Tiny Fey | Level 2 Striker

HP: 12 PD: 16/21/26 AD: 10/15/20

MIG -2 (-1) AGI 3 (4) CHA 2 (3) INT -1 (0)

Skills: Awareness +5, Stealth +4

Languages: Fey

Other Speeds: Ground 3

FEATURES

Pack Tactics: You gain an additional +2 bonus to Attacks against creatures you're Flanking.

ACTIONS (4)

Attack: +4 Save DC: 14 Speed: Fly 5

(1) Claw: Melee Martial Attack vs PD, 2 Slashing and target makes a Physical Save. **Failure:** Target is **Bleeding**.

- **(+1) Flyby:** You can move up to your Speed before or after Attacking without provoking Opportunity Attacks.

(1) Vicious Mockery: Ranged Spell Attack vs AD, 10 Spaces, 1 Psychic and target makes a Charisma Save. **Failure:** Target is **Taunted** by you for 1 Round.

- **(+1) Discombobulate:** Intelligence Save. **Failure:** Target subtracts a d4 on every Check it makes for 1 Round.

(2) Slumber: Contest, 5 Spaces, 2 Space Sphere, Spell Check vs Repeated Intelligence Save. **Success:** Target is **Incapacitated** for 1 minute or until it takes damage, makes a Save against another effect, or another creature within 1 Space spends 1 AP to wake it.

REACTIONS

(1) Fey Escape (1/Round): When you're Hit by a Melee Attack, you can teleport to an unoccupied Space within 5 Spaces.

SKELETON WARRIOR

Description: A reanimated corpse past the point of rotting where only bones remain, armed with ancient equipment for various roles.

Tactics: Skeleton Warriors attack with reckless abandon, using **Sword** and **Shield** to attack anyone close to them. They use **Slings** to attack from afar. They'll try to make sweeping attacks (**Cleave**) at groups of enemies and will **Endure** Heavy Hits.

Lore: These creatures are old combatants animated by spellcasters or lingering necrotic magic. They're popular troops for necromancers due to their use of weapons and the minimal magic needed to create them.

SKELETON WARRIOR

Medium Undead | Level 1 Soldier

HP: 10 PD: 13/18/23 AD: 11/16/21

MIG 3 (4) AGI 1 (2) CHA -2 (-1) INT -1 (-1)

Resistances: Piercing (Half)

Vulnerabilities: Bludgeoning (Double), Radiant (Double)

Immunities: Poison | **Bleeding, Exhausted, Poisoned, Unconscious**

Skills: Awareness +3

Senses: Darkvision 10

Languages: You understand the languages you knew in life, but can't speak.

FEATURES

False Appearance: While you remain motionless, you're indistinguishable from a dead body.

ACTIONS (4)

Attack: +4 Save DC: 14 Speed: 4

(1) **Sling:** Ranged Martial Attack vs PD, 10/30 Spaces, 1 Piercing.

- (+1) **Hinder:** Agility Save. **Failure:** Target is **Hindered** until the end of their next turn.

(1) **Sword:** Melee Martial Attack vs PD, 1 Slashing.

- (+1) **Accuracy:** Add a d6 to your Attack Check.

(2) **Cleave:** Area Martial Attack vs AD, 1 Space Arc, 1 Slashing.

REACTIONS

(1) **Endure:** When you or a creature within 1 Space of you is Hit by an Attack, they take 1 less damage from the Attack.

SMALL MIMIC

Description: A shapeshifter that morphs into small objects like treasure or chests, it takes on a monstrous form when attacking, usually sprouting insectoid legs. Its interior is made of thick crimson fibers, resembling the surface of a cat's tongue. Its pointed tongue is as sharp as a blade.

Tactics: Every Mimic copies an item and lies in wait for a creature to come close enough for attack. They **Snap** at singular enemies and can use their **Tongue** to swipe at groups. If they need to cover a lot of ground, Small Mimics can **Lunge** quite far.

Lore: Mimics have an insatiable hunger and eat any living creature they can, but mostly humanoids. They disguise themselves as mundane objects that lure people towards them, then attack when their prey's guard is down. Mimics grow when they consume enough meat, so Small Mimics are usually very young or starved.

SMALL MIMIC

Medium Aberration | Level 1 Striker

HP: 10 PD: 16/21/26 AD: 21/26/31

MIG 0 (1) AGI 3 (4) CHA 0 (1) INT 1 (2)

Skills: Awareness +5, Acrobatics +5, Athletics +4, Stealth +5

FEATURES

False Appearance: While motionless, you're indistinguishable from a mundane object.

Ambush Predator: Your first Attack each combat deals +3 damage. If the target is **Surprised**, you have ADV on the Attack.

ACTIONS (4)

Attack: +4 Save DC: 14 Speed: 5

(1) **Snap:** Melee Martial Attack vs PD, 1 Piercing + 1 **extra damage** on a Heavy Hit.

(2) **Tongue:** Area Martial Attack vs AD, 1 Space Arc, 1 Slashing + 1 **extra damage** on a Heavy Hit.

(2) **Lunge:** You jump up to your Speed then Melee Martial Attack vs PD, 1 Bludgeoning and target makes a Physical Save. **Failure:** Target falls **Prone**.

SPRITE

Description: A very small fey that glows brightly in a variety of colors, usually only appearing as a mote of light with wings. When closely examined, it has a tiny elf-like body in the center of the light.

Tactics: Sprites don't fight directly, and simply support allies with **Soothing Words** and their **Exposing Light**. If they're up close in a fight, they'll Help their friends with Attacks and other Actions.

Lore: The color a Sprite glows is based on its mood, which changes rapidly. They tend to offer encouragement to people and play mostly harmless pranks. Sprites love to be helpful to heroes, and sometimes seek the companionship of an adventurer just starting their journey.

SPRITE

Micro Fey | Level 0 Leader

HP: 11 PD: **13/18/23** AD: **10/15/20**

MIG **-2 (-1)** AGI **1 (2)** CHA **2 (3)** INT **0 (1)**

Skills: Awareness +4, Acrobatics +3, Influence +4

Senses: Darkvision 10

Languages: Fey

Other Speeds: Ground 1

FEATURES

Helpful: Your Help Die starts at a **d10**.

Guidance: You can use the Help Action on creatures within 5 Spaces.

ACTIONS (4)

Attack: **+3** Save DC: **13** Speed: **Fly 5**

(1) Soothing Words: A creature within 5 Spaces gains **2** Temp HP.

(1) Exposing Light: Contest, 5 Spaces, Spell Check vs Physical Save. **Failure:** Target is **Exposed** for 1 Round.

REACTIONS

(Auto) Empathetic Support: After an ally within 5 Spaces is Hit by an Attack, you can use **Soothing Words** on the creature.

STORM ELEMENTAL

Description: A dense, compacted torrent of rain clouds, hail, and lightning. Its thunder is deafening.

Tactics: These elementals use **Lightning Strikes** to attack from afar and **Hail** to pelt enemies within their body. They can pull creatures around them into their body (see **Vortex Pull**) and create **Booming Thunder** to Daze enemies.

Lore: A living embodiment of a thunderstorm, they are as chaotic and unpredictable. Their emotions can change drastically from one minute to the next, causing them to be quite violent at times.

STORM ELEMENTAL

Huge Elemental | Level 6 Striker

HP: 10 PD: 14/19/24 AD: 9/14/19

MIG -1 (2) AGI 4 (7) CHA -2 (1) INT -2 (1)

Resistances: Bludgeoning (Half), Corrosion (Half), Piercing (Half), Slashing (Half)

Immunities: Lightning, Poison | **Bleeding, Blinded, Burning, Deafened, Grappled, Paralyzed, Poisoned, Prone, Restrained, Tethered, Unconscious**

Skills: Awareness +4, Intimidation +5

FEATURES

Cloud Body: You can occupy other creature's spaces and vice versa (without a check or being **Slowed**). You can move through a gap narrow enough for air to pass through but treat it as Difficult Terrain.

Storm Body: Creatures that occupy your Space are **Slowed, Blinded, and Deafened**.

Diminishing Size: When you become **Bloodied**, you become 1 Size smaller and your Attacks have DisADV. When you become **Well-Bloodied**, this becomes 2 Sizes smaller and your Attacks have DisADV 2.

ACTIONS (4)

Attack: +7 Save DC: 17 Speed: Fly 5

(1) Lightning Strike: Ranged Spell Attack vs AD, 10 Spaces, 3 Lightning. This ignores Close Range Penalty.

• **(+1, Repeatable) Chain:** Choose 1 additional target within 3 Spaces of the original (or previous target if used multiple times) using the same Spell Attack for all Targets.

(2) Hail: [Creatures in Spaces you Occupy] Area Spell Attack vs AD, 2 Bludgeoning + 1 extra damage on a Heavy Hit.

(2) Vortex Pull: [Large or smaller creature] Contest, 1 Space Aura, Spell Check vs Physical Save. **Success:** Target is pulled 1 Space toward your center. **Success (each 5):** Target is pulled +1 Space.

(4) Booming Thunder: Contest, 5 Space Aura, Spell Check vs Might Save. **Success:** Target is **Dazed** and **Stunned** for 1 Round.

SWARM OF BATS

Description: A swarm of small brown bats, loudly flapping and screeching in a large mass.

Tactics: Swarms of Bats screech (see **Echo**) to find and Daze their enemies, then **Swarm** them to Bleed and Impair them. They're weak to effects that target an area.

Lore: Bats that live together in colonies, only attacking when they feel threatened or are being controlled.

SWARM OF BATS

Huge Swarm of Tiny Beasts | Novice Striker

HP: 5

PD: 15/20/25 AD: 5/10/15

MIG -2

AGI 2

CHA 0

INT -2

Immunities: Grappled, Restrained, Tethered

Skills: Awareness +2, Acrobatics +4

Senses: Echosight (see Echo)

FEATURES

Swarm: You can occupy other creature's spaces and vice versa (without a check or being **Slowed**). You can move through a gap as narrow as the size of the creatures that make up your swarm but treat it as Difficult Terrain.

Significant Diminishing Numbers: You can't heal or gain Temp HP. When you become **Bloodied**, you become 1 Size smaller and your Attacks have DisADV. When you become **Well-Bloodied**, this becomes 2 Sizes smaller and your Attacks have DisADV 2.

Poor Eyesight: You have DisADV on Attacks against a creature not revealed by Echo, unless they've Attacked you since the end of your last turn.

ACTIONS (3)

Attack: +2

Save DC: 12

Speed: Fly 5

(1) Echo: You screech, revealing all creatures within a 15 Spaces of you to yourself and any creature with Echosight for 1 round.

- **(+1) Louder:** [Creatures in Spaces you occupy] Contest, Martial Check vs Mental Save. **Success:** Target is **Dazed** for 1 round.

(1) Swarm: Melee Attack vs AD, 1 Piercing.

- **(+1) Bleed:** Target makes an Agility Save. **Failure:** Target is **Bleeding**.

- **(+1) Impair:** Target makes a Might Save. **Failure:** Target is **Impaired** for 1 round (considered a Basic Disease).

WOLF

Description: A large, savage canine with long, sharp teeth and claws that howls to start a hunt. Their fur is often black and gray, but can be brown or white in certain environments.

Tactics: If an ally hasn't Grappled a target, they **Bite** and **Grapple** one. Once they've Grappled a creature, they Flank and **Tear Apart**.

Lore: While wolves can be encountered alone or in a pair, they're usually found in moderately sized packs of 3 or more. They cause trouble when too close to civilization, often eating horses and livestock while preventing civilians from safely doing their day to day work in the crop fields and forests.

WOLF

Medium Beast | Level 0 Soldier

HP: 11

PD: 12/17/22 AD: 10/15/20

MIG 1 (2)

AGI 2 (3)

CHA 0 (1)

INT -3 (-2)

Skills: Awareness +6, Acrobatics +4, Stealth +4, Survival +4

Senses: Darkvision 10

FEATURES

Keen Senses: You have ADV on Awareness Checks made to hear or smell.

Pack Tactics: You gain an additional +2 bonus to Attacks against creatures you're Flanking.

ACTIONS (4)

Attack: +3

Save DC: 13

Speed: 8

(1) Bite: Melee Martial Attack vs PD, 1 Piercing.

- **(+1) Grapple:** Might Save. **Failure:** Target is **Grappled**.

- **(+1) Slow:** Agility Save. **Failure:** Target is **Slowed** until the end of its next turn.

(1) Tear Apart: [A **Grappled** target], Melee Martial Attack vs AD, 1 Piercing and target makes a Physical Save. **Failure:** Target is **Bleeding**.

WYVERN

Description: A two-legged dragon with a barbed tail. It smells of rot and has a terrifying roar.

Tactics: These dragons focus on grabbing creatures with their **Talons**, and then flying away with them to separate them from other enemies. They'll **Bite** singular enemies to inflict heavy damage, and attack with their wings when surrounded (see **Wing Strike**). When threatened by multiple enemies, they'll try to poison at least one at a time with their Stinger while fighting the rest, and using their roar to Intimidate them (see **Intimidating Roar**). Their cold-blooded nature makes them susceptible to ice magic and cold weather.

Lore: Wyverns are dragons that live in mountain ranges and mesas bordering desserts. They hunt large prey in pairs or packs throughout their vast territories, and their barbed tail has a potent poison.

WYVERN

Large Dragon | Level 6 Striker

HP: 19 PD: 16/21/26 AD: 14/19/24

MIG 4 (7) AGI 3 (6) CHA -2 (1) INT 1 (4)

Vulnerabilities: Cold (Double)

Skills: Awareness +6, Athletics +8, Intimidation +8

Senses: Darkvision 10

Other Speeds: Ground 4

FEATURES

Keen Senses: You have ADV on Awareness Checks made to hear or smell.

Pack Tactics: You gain an additional +2 bonus to Attacks against creatures you're Flanking.

ACTIONS (4)

Attack: +7 Save DC: 17 Speed: Fly 8

(1) Bite: Melee Marital Attack vs PD, 4 Piercing + 1 extra damage on a Heavy Hit.

(1) Talon: Melee Marital Attack vs PD, 3 Slashing and target makes a Physical Save. **Failure:** Target is **Grappled**. **Failure (5):** While **Grappled**, the target is also **Restrained**.

(2) Wing Strike: Melee Marital Attack vs AD, 1 Space Aura, 3 Bludgeoning and target makes a Physical Save. **Failure:** Target falls **Prone**.

(2) Stinger: Melee Martial Attack vs PD, 2 Spaces, 1 Piercing and target makes a Might Save. **Failure:** Target takes 2 Poison damage at the start of each turn for 1 minute (considered a Basic Poison).

(2) Intimidating Roar: Contest, 5 Space Aura, Intimidation vs Repeated Charisma Save. **Success:** Target is **Intimidated** by you for 1 minute.

ZOMBIE

Description: Reeking of death, Zombie shapes and size can vary as much as the rotting corpses used to create them. They emit low groans as they slowly trudge toward living flesh.

Tactics: Zombies mindlessly **Strike** and **Grapple** a creature, then **Bite** and **Infect** them.

Lore: These creatures are corpses animated by spellcasters or lingering necrotic magic. Leaving an area of lingering necrotic magic uncleansed can result in a Zombie hoard or the forming of stronger undead.

ZOMBIE

Medium Undead | Level 0 Brute

HP: 13 PD: 6/11/16 AD: 9/14/19

MIG 2 (3) AGI -1 (0) CHA -1 (0) INT -2 (-1)

Resistances: Umbral (Half)

Vulnerabilities: Physical (Double)

Immunities: Poison | **Poisoned, Unconscious**

Skills: Awareness +2

FEATURES

Unrelenting: The only way you can be reduced below 1 HP is by a Heavy Hit or an Attack that deals Radiant damage.

ACTIONS (4)

Attack: +3 Save DC: 13 Speed: 3

(1) Strike: Melee Martial Attack vs PD, 1 Bludgeoning.

• **(+1) Grapple:** Might Save. **Failure:** Target is **Grappled**.

(1) Bite: [A **Grappled** target], Melee Martial Attack vs AD, 2 Piercing.

• **(+2) Infect:** Repeated Might Save. **Failure:** Target is **Impaired** for 1 minute (considered a Basic Disease).



DC20 GLOSSARY

GENERAL

Area Attack: An Attack against creatures within a specified area, such as an Aura, Cone, or Line. These Attacks don't have DisADV against creatures within 1 Space of the attacker.

MONSTERS

(Auto) [reaction's name]: These types of Reactions happen automatically, without a creature needing to spend AP or even being able to spend AP (such as when it's Incapacitated). They're often used for on-death Actions and rare interactions that don't require the creature's input to activate.

Round Action: Unless the monster is Incapacitated, these Actions happen at the start of the listed round of combat before any creature's turn.

[Damage] (Absorb): This creature has Immunity to this damage type. When this damage type is dealt against the creature, it regains HP equal to half the damage prevented.

Hovering Speed: A Flying Speed that allows the creature to stay aloft even after gaining the Prone Condition.

Reaction Points (RP): At the end of a turn, the monster can spend any number of Reaction Points (RP) to take a number of Actions equal to the number of PCs occupying that turn. Reaction Points (RP) are regained at start of the round.



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